



Program Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning and Impact Assessment (MELIA) Plan

Multifunctional Landscapes Science Program

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Program/Accelerator overview

Description

In response to the global challenges of land degradation, climate change, biodiversity loss, water scarcity, and food insecurity, the Multifunctional Landscapes Science Program (MFL SP) applies a systems-based approach that builds on an understanding of landscapes as complex and interlinked social-ecological systems—guided by a “source to sea” perspective to drive integrated solutions that reconcile production, conservation, and restoration objectives.

The Multifunctional Landscapes SP envisions thriving, biodiverse, low-emissions, and healthy landscapes that are managed holistically to deliver resilient and equitable livelihoods, biodiversity and ecosystem gains, and the production and consumption of healthy, nutritious food, while staying within planetary boundaries.

In this vision, landscapes are stewarded by diverse stakeholders who co-design inclusive technological, socioecological, and institutional innovations; engage in policy processes; and are supported by inclusive governance and effective planning. Indigenous Peoples and Local Communities (IPLC), women, youth, and socially currently marginalized groups are integral participants, and beneficiaries.

This vision is operationalized by bringing together the collective strengths of key CGIAR Initiatives including Agroecology, Nature-Positive Solutions, Livestock and Climate, and the Environmental Health and Biodiversity Impact Area Platform (EHBIAP) as well as related bilateral projects. These efforts converge into a global science platform for action, grounded in systems thinking and landscape approaches, to address complex sustainability challenges across sectors and regions.

A defining feature of this vision is its deliberate focus on reconciling and balancing production, restoration, and conservation objectives simultaneously across scales, spanning from “farm to fork” and “net to plate.” Through a shared landscape vision, the platform enables coordinated, evidence-based action toward multifunctional, resilient, and inclusive agri-food and aquatic systems.

In our vision, the [agroecology principles](#) including nature-positive, regenerative and other complementary solutions will guide the achievement of socio-ecological gains. The Program is committed to transdisciplinary research co-implemented with stakeholders and partners using the Living Labs approach (see section 8.2). It pays attention to mixed systems including agroforestry, biodiversity and water systems as recommended in the 21st meeting of the CGIAR System Council (p.3).

Components

AoW1 Solutions and Innovations: agroecology, nature-positive, regenerative, and nutrition-sensitive

Integrating science-based experimentation with local knowledge, AoW1 collaborates with national and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, private sector, and researchers in target multifunctional landscapes to create “bundles” of solutions and innovations suited to specific contexts. These solutions and innovations consist of technological, socioecological, organizational and institutional innovations aimed at enhancing food production and human diets, while also supporting ecosystem restoration, biodiversity protection as well as climate adaptation and mitigation. AoW1 employs human-centered design and transdisciplinary approaches to harness local knowledge and strengthen stakeholder efforts and participatory co-innovation strategies to develop basic, advanced, and cutting-edge solutions and innovations that are socially inclusive and gender-transformative. The solutions and innovations are co-developed to optimize sustainable use and stewardship of agricultural landscapes, terrestrial and aquatic agroecosystems and their agrobiodiversity, forests, rangelands, water bodies, peatlands, and native genetic resources. AoW 1 addresses the needs of landscape users and surrounding areas, while sustainably safeguarding natural resources and ecosystem services. AoW1 will develop farm- and farming-system-level solutions; conservation, management and restoration to enhance the regenerative use of common pool resources; nature positive solutions to integrate protected area management with livelihood options; as well as nutrition-sensitive innovations that enhance dietary quality for the most vulnerable inhabitants within target landscapes; supported by actor-centered advisory and training to anchor and scale solutions. The eco-agrifood system solutions and innovations will be bundled following visioning and priority areas identified in AoW 2 to optimize landscape multifunctionality. High-level outputs include validated and bundled practices, technologies, and tools to a) enhance farm-level productivity, climate resilience, and sustainability within landscapes; b) achieve climate-Integrated Landscape Management; c) optimize management of common pool resources and derived ecosystem services; d) protect resources degradation and restore degraded areas to enhance ecosystem benefits; e) streamline protected area management with local livelihood benefits; f) enhance nutrition; and g) apply advisory and training innovations to widely disseminate validated solutions.

AoW2 Landscape Planning and Governance

AoW2 lays the ground for enabling the integration of eco-agri-food system solutions and innovation bundles validated in AoW1, promote land-sharing and land-sparing strategies, and enhance landscape connectivity and multifunctionality within shared visions. AoW 2 envisions national and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs co-planning and co-governing multifunctional landscapes by identifying and prioritizing investment areas for bundled eco-agri-food system solutions. This includes designing layered mosaics of land and resource use that optimize sustainable food production, climate-resilient livelihoods, and environmental outcomes—particularly biodiversity—while balancing land-use synergies and trade-

offs. Realizing this vision requires addressing competing and conflicting land uses that undermine food system productivity, sustainability, and resilience, and that compromise the livelihoods and security of land users. The Multifunctional Landscapes Program collaborates with partners to tackle these ‘wicked problems’ of landscape planning, management, and governance, supporting the development of inclusive, participatory, and multi-layered approaches. In response, the AoW 2 high-level outputs will include a) a knowledge base on landscape stakeholders, issues and potential bundles of solutions for each landscape; b) multistakeholder visioning processes and revisions in each landscape informed by this knowledge base and integrating potential bundles of eco-agrifood system solutions and innovations; c) the identification of priority areas of investment across scale, based on these shared visions, to identify the most appropriate bundles of solutions and innovations; and d) appropriate inclusive governance and management structures to optimize multifunctionality of each landscape.

AoW3 Markets and Business models

Supporting the pathway of co-creation of knowledge on markets and consumer preferences together with innovative inclusive business models and financial mechanisms, this AoW lays the ground for the scaling and sustainability of the bundle of solutions and innovations developed. AoW3 envisions producer organizations, consumer organizations, national and sub-national public actors, private sector actors, and finance actors co-creating knowledge on markets and consumer preferences and co-developing inclusive business models, market and non-market incentives as well as financial mechanisms for the multifunctional landscapes solutions co-developed under AoW1 and prioritized under AoW2. It supports visions toward resilient livelihoods (as identified under AoW2) by focusing on the financial and economic viability of landscape approaches. AoW3 achieves its vision through improved market and non-market incentives with innovative financing schemes to enhance landscape multifunctionality and improve access to sustainable food and non-food products. AoW3 co-promotes territorial markets as key retail hubs/outlets for accessing fresh and healthy diets. It further works with stakeholders to create green business opportunities and income-generating activities by monetizing ecosystem services. AoW3 high-level outputs, combined with AoW4 solutions on enabling policy and institutional environment, leverage market incentives for thriving Multifunctional Landscapes. They include: a) demand-driven capacity strengthening of producer organizations and key landscape actors; b) co-designed inclusive business models optimizing multifunctionality of landscapes, influencing consumer choices and stimulating societal demand for ecosystem services; c) co-designed inclusive market and non-market mechanisms for optimizing ecosystem services in multifunctional landscapes; and d) co-designed financial services based on assessments of financial ecosystem, promising innovative options and partnerships agreements for each landscape.

AoW4 Institutions and Policies

The work of the AoW4 underpins that of AoW 1, 2 and 3, by enabling policies, strategies, and institutional arrangements that are key for effective and inclusive public and private multifunctional landscapes investments. AoW4 envisions national governments, sub-national and local policy

actors in target countries using evidence from collaborative research to inform policy processes and guide investment prioritization for multifunctional landscapes. This AoW contributes to the Multifunctional Landscapes vision by co-producing knowledge products and co-developing strategies and tools, grounded in theoretical rigor and empirically validated evidence, to influence policies, institutional processes, and financing mechanisms that support integrated landscape management. AoW4 responds to multiple needs: (a) to support landscape actors in policy engagement, advocacy, and effective implementation, working closely with AoW2 and AoW7; (b) to foster polycentric governance and inclusive multi-stakeholder platforms, in collaboration with AoW2 and AoW5, to address power imbalances and social exclusion; (c) to enhance policy effectiveness, coherence, and investment prioritization, particularly in nature-based sectors such as biodiversity, forests, rangelands, and other natural resources; and (d) to strengthen tenure systems and property rights, with attention to growing land demands, ensuring sustainability and equity across different tenure types—especially for socially excluded groups, women, and youth. The AoW also tailors capacity-strengthening tools to enhance engagement, implementation, and coordination of inclusive policy processes. Its efforts are anchored in multi-stakeholder platforms and supported by knowledge products that document institutional empowerment pathways, showing how enabling policies and institutional arrangements can deliver more inclusive and resilient development outcomes.

AoW5 Gender Equality, Social Inclusion and Fairness

This AoW supports all other AoWs through capacity sharing and knowledge integration and informing strategies and interventions addressing the root causes of inequality between women and men together with other forms of discrimination in resource access, decision-making, and agency, as well as the structural barriers and lack of opportunities for Youth that pose significant obstacles to fair and equitable rural development. AoW5 envisions national and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs, finance sector actors, and researchers, integrating gender equality, youth and social inclusion (GEYSI) and fairness principles and approaches into processes and practices for multifunctional landscapes. Higher levels of fairness, equality and social inclusion in multifunctional landscapes, from the household to the landscape level, will raise the quality of life in rural communities and the overall capacity of populations to innovate and to build and maintain resilient livelihoods and landscapes. AoW5 contributes to this vision by: a) developing or strengthening participatory research tools and methodologies for understanding the context, history, causes and influences of fairness and GEYSI in each multifunctional landscape; b) co-designing gender transformative approaches to change discourses and norms; c) supporting the gender responsive and fair implementation of innovations and interventions; d) strengthening capacity of partners on transdisciplinary, gender responsive and socially inclusive approaches; e) supporting the development and implementation of responsible scaling strategies; f) adapting GEYSI-responsive and -transformative approaches to landscape perspective; and g) develop research on emerging (new) topics and generating evidence on new directions for achieving quality of life and social equity resilience from a human perspective. These lead to two key outputs: GEYSI-responsive and transformative approaches and methodologies from

the individual to the landscape scale; social incentives and behavioral change mechanisms for people and organizations to shape and harness inclusive and thriving multifunctional landscapes.

AoW6 Performance Assessment and Evidence Generation

This AoW contributes to all 2030 Program-level outcomes and is closely interconnected with the efforts of all other AoWs to generate and strategically frame actionable evidence on the impacts of innovations in multifunctional landscapes to inform policy coherence and institutional empowerment pathways and guide the integration of Multifunctional Landscapes science into the research, planning and implementation strategies of national and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs, development actors and researchers.

AoW6 envisions national and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs, development actors and researchers using robust performance assessment frameworks to monitor the progress of multifunctional landscapes and to develop incentives that sustain their transformation. Central to this work is a transdisciplinary, solution-oriented research approach that integrates diverse scientific disciplines with the lived knowledge and priorities of local stakeholders. This ensures that outputs are outcome-driven, aligned with user needs, and grounded in strong stakeholder ownership. The outputs of AoW6 are co-designed with landscape stakeholders and anchored in their collective visions and experiences. These include: (a) a comprehensive set of tools and indicators to facilitate holistic, cross-scale performance assessments of agrifood systems by diverse metrics users; (b) context-specific performance assessment frameworks, co-developed and applied with stakeholders; (c) a stakeholder-centered knowledge and information hub, co-created with decision makers from local to global levels; and (d) digital twin landscapes, developed using transdisciplinary modeling. This AoW contributes to all 2030 Program-level outcomes and is closely interconnected with the efforts of all other AoWs.

AoW7 Global Engagement and Learning

Sustainable impacts require globally strategic thinking and enhanced capacities of all landscape actors through strengthening and sharing experience. This AoW supports the work of the other AoW by informing policy coherence and institutional empowerment pathways and guide the integration of Multifunctional Landscapes science into national and international policy frameworks including SDGs, NBSAPs, NDCs, LDN targets, and agrifood transformation plans. As a support area, AoW7 focuses on engagement and learning that adaptatively informs and reshapes research priorities based on feedback loops. AoW7 will use knowledge management, capacity sharing, communications, engagement, and feedback-loop strategies to enhance the uptake of the scientific evidence generated by the Multifunctional Landscapes SP's AoW6, while adapting research priorities to the evolution of megatrends and shifting demands of the landscape actors at national, regional and global scales.

Strong collaboration with the Science Programs on Scaling for Impact and Policy Innovations and the Accelerator on Capacity Sharing will be pursued to elevate the Multifunctional Landscapes SP

agenda. The main outputs of AoW7 include: a) capacity development strategy for regional and global engagement on multifunctional landscapes based on landscape actor's training needs; b) a community of practice for knowledge sharing targeted at regional and global policy actors; c) knowledge management toolkits on multifunctional landscapes science, practices, and policies; d) cross-CGIAR assessment frameworks of impact indicators on environmental health, biodiversity, and ecosystem services; and e) multifunctional landscapes engagement and advocacy framework and annual action-plans. This AoW supports the work of the other AoW by informing policy coherence and institutional empowerment pathways and guide the integration of Multifunctional Landscapes science into national and international policy frameworks including SDGs, NBSAPs, NDCs, LDN targets, and agrifood transformation plans.

Theory of change

Narrative

The Multifunctional Landscapes Program has a specific systems-based approach that treats landscapes as complex, interlinked social-ecological systems. Indeed, to co-create solutions with rural communities and wider society requires an integrated research approach that goes far beyond individual innovations applied in piecemeal fashion. Such an approach must instead be centered on landscapes, which encompass not only single agricultural lands but the surrounding socio-economic and natural ecosystems, including forests and aquatic ecosystems.

The vision and the outcomes that it aims to achieve are grounded in human-centered design and transdisciplinary approaches, where bundles of agroecological, nature-positive and nutrition-sensitive solutions and innovations can only be adopted at scale when supported by inclusive land and resource use planning and governance, market and financial mechanisms, and policies that are grounded in evidence and learning processes. This holistic, systems-level approach is based on multifunctional landscapes to delivering healthy, nutritious diets and ecosystem health by aligning sustainable food production, and consumption with ecosystem restoration and biodiversity conservation.

Our program implementation strategy is to work within selected landscapes to design and evaluate solutions with partners taking the findings to country and regional levels. We will work with stakeholders across diverse landscapes, from source to sea, including forests, agroforestry systems, rural and urban areas, mountains, grasslands, savannas, deserts, rangelands, rivers, lakes, islands, riparian zones, floodplains, and wetlands. We consider the interconnectedness of water, land, and people to address food security, biodiversity, climate, and livelihoods challenges holistically. Sustainable management of this system by diverse landscape stakeholders aims to reconcile economic development with the management of water, forest, soil, and other natural resources, contributing to better livelihoods, healthier diets and heightened resilience in the face of climate change impacts and other pressures.

The Multifunctional Landscapes Program applies transdisciplinary approaches and works with relevant Programs and Accelerators building on well-established partnerships and forging new ones to co-identify, co-design, and co-implement systemic interventions that harmonize environmental sustainability with human development goals and help develop biodiverse, productive, resilient, and low emissions land and aquascapes. It integrates agricultural, ecological, aquatic, and other ecosystems from ‘source to sea.’

Landscape stakeholders that the Program engages include: (a) (smallholder) farmers, such as crop producers, pastoralists, herders, fishers, aquatic food producers, forest users and large-scale landholders; (b) value-chain actors engaged in food processing, storage, distribution, marketing, and selling; (c) consumers (rural, peri-urban, and urban); (d) scientists from academia and NARES; (e) national and sub-national public actors, including extensionists and other technical support providers; (f) suppliers of inputs and machinery, those who support maintenance; (g) the private sector; (h) NGOs, CSOs, development organizations, land-use organizations; (i) local, regional, national governments and authorities, civil society who plan, execute, and monitor the agriculture/environment sector; (j) local communities living in landscapes; (k) international landscape organizations; international fora engaged in the conservation-human health-development space; (l) the financial sector.

Major research questions are:

1. How can multifunctional landscapes be effectively managed through optimal bundles of eco-agrifood system solutions that simultaneously enhance productivity, biodiversity, nutrition security, resilience, and social equity while minimizing trade-offs across different landscape contexts?
2. What institutional frameworks, governance models, and collective action mechanisms best support inclusive and adaptive landscape management, enabling coordination across scales and empowering diverse stakeholders including women, youth, and marginalized communities?
3. How can fair and inclusive market mechanisms, business models, and policy instruments be co-designed to capture economic and non-economic values of ecosystem services, attract finance, and incentivize equitable generation of multiple benefits while strengthening organizational capacity of local communities?
4. What transformative approaches, strategies, and enabling conditions promote scaling and replication of evidence-based solutions within and between landscapes while optimizing gender equality, social inclusion, food sovereignty, and quality of life outcomes?
5. What cost-effective, participatory tools and assessment frameworks can measure risks, impacts, trade-offs, and synergies of multifunctional landscape interventions in near real-time while empowering diverse stakeholders with evidence-based decision-making capabilities?

6. How can the Multifunctional Landscapes Program strategically align with larger investment Programs, global commitments, and partnerships to maximize impact at scale while fostering knowledge sharing and influencing policy discourse through cutting-edge scientific evidence?

Vision

The Multifunctional Landscapes SP envisions thriving, biodiverse, low-emissions, and healthy landscapes that are managed holistically to deliver resilient and equitable livelihoods, biodiversity and ecosystem gains, and the production and consumption of healthy, nutritious food, while staying within planetary boundaries. In this vision, landscapes are co-created and stewarded by diverse stakeholders who co-design inclusive technological, socioecological, and institutional innovations; engage in policy processes; and are supported by inclusive governance and effective planning. Indigenous Peoples and Local Communities (IPLC), women, youth, and socially currently marginalized groups are integral participants, and beneficiaries.

This vision is operationalized by bringing together the collective strengths of key CGIAR Initiatives including Agroecology, Nature-Positive Solutions, Livestock and Climate, and the Environmental Health and Biodiversity Impact Area Platform (EHBIAP) as well as related bilateral projects. These efforts converge into a global science platform for action, grounded in systems thinking and landscape approaches, to address complex sustainability challenges across sectors and regions.

A defining feature of this Program is its deliberate focus on reconciling and balancing production, restoration, and conservation objectives across scales, spanning from “farm to fork” and “net to plate.” Through a shared landscape vision, the platform enables coordinated, evidence-based action toward multifunctional, resilient, and inclusive agri-food and aquatic systems.

Program Logic

The underlying logic of the Program is that by collaboratively designing nutrition-sensitive solutions rooted in agroecological, nature-positive, regenerative, conservation, and restoration principles (AoW1) —supported by inclusive (AoW5) business models (AoW3), enabling governance (AoW2), coherent policies (AoW4), and grounded in evidence (AoW6) and continuous learning (AoW7)— and implementing these solutions in priority ecosystems through integrated landscape approaches guided by agroecological principles geared towards nature-positive outcomes, it is possible to help realize healthier and more nutritious food systems, foster resilient and equitable livelihoods, and enhance biodiversity and ecosystem gains.

These AoWs form an interconnected system where AoW1 develops context-specific bundles of agroecological, nature-positive and nutrition-sensitive solutions and innovations, AoW2 enables stakeholders through knowledge, capacity, tools and platforms, to design governance frameworks and priority investment areas for implementing these solutions at landscape scale, AoW3

contributes to economic viability through co-designed market mechanisms and business models and tailored capacity strengthening for producer organizations, while AoW4 supports co-creation of knowledge, capacity and tools to develop an enabling, coherent and coordinated policy environment. Throughout this process, AoW5 ensures gender equality and social inclusion principles, capacity and adapted tools are embedded across all interventions. Through iterative feedback loops AoW6 provides performance assessment frameworks to monitor progress and generate evidence to inform decision-making and refine solutions, governance, business models, and policies, whilst AoW7 facilitates global knowledge sharing and policy integration to scale impact beyond targeted landscapes. The ultimate goal of this interconnected system is to shift conflicts and competition among goals in the landscape to synergies that optimize multifunctionality and achieve thriving landscapes.

In order to achieve the vision, by 2030, the Multifunctional Landscapes Program aims to contribute to **five major outcomes** through **five interconnected pathways**:

- 1. 2030 OC-1. Farmers, fishers, herders, foresters, forest and water users groups, national and sub-national public actors, and private sector actors in the targeted landscapes apply technological, socio-ecological, policy and/or institutional innovations that enhance food production, ecosystem restoration and gains, biodiversity conservation and protection, social cohesion and resilience, and healthy diets in thriving Multifunctional Landscapes.**

To achieve this outcome, the first **pathway** integrates **science-based experimentation with local knowledge and co-creates “bundles” of solutions suited to specific contexts** for enhanced food production, ecosystem restoration and gains, biodiversity conservation and protection, and healthy diets. Research approaches focus on agroecological, restorative, regenerative, and climate-resilient management of farms and landscapes, supported by actor-centered advisory and training to anchor and scale solutions. Innovative research methods will be applied across different nested scales. Soil, water and (agro)biodiversity solutions will be applied on farm and at plot levels in an integrated manner. This will include genetic approaches for the deployment of (agro)bioversity to ensure adaptation to climate change and to monitor changes in soil biodiversity, focusing on neglected and underutilized species and more adapted varieties for major crops. This work will also aim at better understanding the feedback between below and above ground biodiversity. In addition, plots and farms will be managed in an organized manner, e.g. through cooperatives, for better integration with markets. At the landscape level, depending on the priorities, different tools and methods will be used for restoration of degraded land, watershed management to reduce erosion (including through bio-physical structure). Selection of crops and species to be used in farm and landscape levels will be selected based on their nutritional profile. Finally, specific tools and methods such 24hours recall will be used to change consumer behaviors and ensure improvement of diets by specifically targeting consumer for greater awareness on the importance of better diets. eDNA will be used to monitor biodiversity changes in the landscapes, e.g. from spider webs and by collecting soil samples. Near real-time monitoring system by AoW6 will be used to assess changes and progress.

- 2. 2030 OC-2. National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, local communities, private sector, NGOs and CSOs actively implement inclusive land and resource use planning and landscape governance (investment plans, multistakeholder platforms, etc.) to optimize landscape multi-functionality.**

To achieve this outcome, the second **pathway** of the Program on enhancing **multi-stakeholder decision-making, inclusive land-, and natural-resource use, planning and governance, which support pathway 1 through enabling multi-stakeholder decision-making**. The Program works with landscape stakeholders to develop a vision for optimizing multifunctionality (production, restoration, conservation) in their landscape. Research is undertaken on how this vision can be operationalized with bundles of solutions drawing from AoW1 and other options. Geospatial analyses and integrated modelling techniques are used to co-identify priority areas for investment followed by socio-economic and ecological characterization. Spatially explicit modelling, scenario analysis, cost-benefit and trade-off analyses, serious game approaches are used to optimize appropriate land use and management options for the priority areas and/or other landscapes under consideration. Digital landscape twins are integral part of the work. An appropriate governance system (likely polycentric) is being co-developed and actioned. Research approaches begin with tools for analyzing landscape context and stakeholders, building on those developed under the Initiatives—such as multistakeholder mapping, spatially explicit threat analysis, and analysis of power dynamics. A [Vision-to-Action approach](#) under revision guides co-development of a shared vision to optimize landscape multifunctionality. Gender Equality, Youth and Social Inclusion (GEYSI) and power dynamics are integrated throughout, with efforts to address inequities in both research and interventions.

- 3. 2030 OC-3 National and sub-national public actors, market and finance sector actors design and implement coordinated, inclusive and coherent policy, institutional, organizational, market and non-market innovations that support the transition to thriving Multifunctional Landscapes**

To achieve this outcome and scale pathway 1 through incentives to the use of solutions and innovation bundles, the third **pathway** of the Program focuses on the **co-creation of knowledge on markets and consumer preferences together with innovative inclusive business models (deploying decision support tools and protocols) and financial mechanisms**, such as green business opportunities. Bioeconomy, payments for ecosystem services and circular economy are implemented to support the multifunctional landscapes transition process. Multi-Criteria Decision-Making (MCDM) methods, market-driven financial projections, agroforestry cash flow projections (leveraging market intelligence) are being employed to achieve the outcomes. The work is underpinned by **enabling policies, strategies, and institutional arrangements that are key for effective and inclusive public and private multifunctional landscapes investments**. It includes analytical frameworks for policy alignment across sectors, ex ante and/or ex post impact assessment of alternative policy or investment options, political economy of key multifunctional landscapes processes, desired institutional changes and coordination for multifunctional landscapes: Power

balance & mapping, exploring stakeholder endogenous preferences and behavioral attributes for institutional change pathways.

4. 2030 OC-4. Marginalized people in each Multifunctional Landscape participate in the implementation of the plans, governance, organizational or institutional innovations, and business models, benefiting from the restoration and conservation of landscapes and transformation of eco-agri-food systems.

To achieve this outcome, the fourth **pathway** of the Program underlies the previous 3 pathways by **co-creating opportunities for vulnerable groups, Indigenous People and Local Communities (IPLCs), women and youth through transforming eco-agrifood system, and restoration and conservation of landscapes enhances fairness and gender equality, youth and social inclusion (GEYSI)**. This pathway supports capacity sharing and knowledge integration, and informing strategies and interventions aimed to address the root causes of inequality between women and men together with other forms of discrimination in resource access, decision-making, and agency, as well as the structural barriers and lack of opportunities for Youth that pose significant obstacles to fair and equitable rural development. Research approaches focus on collaboration across AoWs to mainstream gender-responsive research and social inclusion (“Do no harm – leave no one behind”). GEYSI approaches and methods are adapted to a landscape perspective to include emerging topics like resilience, quality of life, or social movements to understand and build the evidence base on the social incentives for people and organizations to transition to equitable and sustainable multifunctional landscapes and invest in their management. Innovative methods include targeted gender-responsive and transformative research methods at organizational and landscape scales, polyvocal spaces and community dialogues; qualitative and quantitative formative social science research, responsible scaling ([GenderUp](#)), and agency and behavioral change approaches to system change ([ACT framework](#)) that are co-developed with stakeholders.

5. 2030 OC-5 National, regional, and global actors use scientifically-sound evidence and capacities on the benefits of thriving Multifunctional Landscapes to engage in global and regional agenda settings and policy discourse.

To achieve this outcome and support all the other 4 pathways through global engagement and learning, the fifth **pathway** of the Program generates and strategically frames **actionable evidence on the impacts of innovations in multifunctional landscapes to inform policy coherence and institutional empowerment pathways and guide the integration of multifunctional landscapes science into national and international policy frameworks** including SDGs, NBSAPs, NDCs, LDN targets, and agrifood transformation plans. Research approaches focus on needs-based capacity sharing, and knowledge management for a shared vision related to environmental health, biodiversity, and ecosystem services. This includes real-time learning dashboards, facilitation of Communities of Practice and Learning Networks, the compilation of evidence and capacity sharing to support policy advocacy, and the development of impact indicator assessment frameworks to effectively engage with the global policy arena on global and regional agenda settings and policy discourse. Evidence generation leverages citizen science and artificial intelligence (AI) for data

collection, management and analysis. Integrative/whole farm/landscape dynamic modelling and foresight techniques address the lack of evidence on the production approaches to be tested. The Program includes digital twin landscapes, designed through ex post and foresight modelling approaches in combination with AI.

These pathways are achieved through seven Areas of Work described in the Program/Accelerator overview of this document.

The seven AoW connect through these five pathways to jointly achieve the 2030 Program outcomes. The starting point is an iterative process to identify, test and validate bundles of solutions and innovations at the farm, common-pool resource, and protected areas level, including climate-smart adaptation and mitigation strategies and recommendations, through targeted advisory support (**AoW1**). This enables stakeholders to engage in agroecology, nature-positive, regenerative and nutrition-sensitive approaches optimizing landscape functionality from farms to protected areas. The **assumption** is that adoption is fostered by providing bundles that address specific needs in a transdisciplinary manner, supported by national and regional stakeholders that are willing and able to articulate their efforts to scale them. Priority investment areas are identified based on shared visions of thriving landscapes, establishing inclusive land use plans and governance structures to optimize management vis-à-vis landscape conditions and socio-economic characteristics (**AoW2**). The **assumption** is that landscape stakeholders are willing and able to engage with new or existing multistakeholder platforms, supported by science-based processes and tools adapted to fit their needs.

The bundles of solutions and innovations are supported by increased organizational and marketing capacity, co-designed business models, market and non-market mechanisms for ecosystem services, and adapted financial mechanisms (**AoW3**), **assuming** that landscape stakeholders articulate their efforts to effectively co-design, develop, implement, and scale these market and financial innovations. Co-designed tools, evidence, and dialogue spaces will enable stakeholders to inform policy changes, incentives, coordination mechanisms and institutions advancing multifunctionality at multiple levels (**AoW4**). The **assumption** is that program partners are willing and able to effectively engage with and influence decision-makers at national and regional levels, who are motivated to participate actively in the co-development, coordination and promotion of policy processes. Additionally, the prioritized incentives empower farmers and other food system actors to adopt, participate in, and scale multifunctional landscapes approaches. Gender equality, youth, and social inclusion responsive and transformative approaches will enable stakeholder participation in multifunctional landscape spaces and co-design of policies addressing marginalized people's challenges, leading to social incentives and behavioral change mechanisms that will drive the transitions towards thriving multifunctional landscapes (**AoW5**). The **assumption** is that better understanding of issues like quality of life, social equity and food sovereignty enables landscape stakeholders to operationalize incentives for social change.

Comprehensive set of tools and indicators, holistic as well as context-specific assessment frameworks will capture diverse performance dimensions linked to the solutions and innovations

fostered, and the piloting of digital twin landscapes, will support evidence-based decision-making (**AoW6**). The key **assumption** is that landscape stakeholders consider performance evidence as a critical component for effective decision making (planning, prioritizing, targeting). Communities of Practice, equipped with knowledge management toolkits, will enable Program partners to communicate on the solutions optimizing landscape multifunctionality. Cross-CGIAR assessment frameworks will contribute to the incorporation of impact indicators on environmental health, biodiversity, and ecosystem services in the institutional strategies of CGIAR and regional and global stakeholders. The Multifunctional landscapes engagement and advocacy framework will support partners engaged in updating NBSAPs and LDN targets aligned with sustainability goals (**AoW7**). The key **assumption** is that CGIAR and the Program partners actively engage in knowledge sharing to strengthen their influence in agenda setting and policy discourse through user-centered and scientifically-sound resources. In the selected multifunctional landscapes, the Program employs action research methods in a bottom-up partnership strategy aimed at ensuring continuity and expansion of local engagement and ownership, as well as enriching research and policy agendas. International research centers and universities share leadership responsibility for the Program's collaborative research and innovation.

ToC diagrams

<https://toc.mel.cgiar.org/report/addfac0e-2c17-4985-87af-531e9364eec1>

Results framework

Program/Accelerator results framework

See attachment in folder, and also available on the ToC board:

<https://toc.mel.cgiar.org/toc/addfac0e-2c17-4985-87af-531e9364eec1?relatedFlowId=438bbe30-ed45-42d1-bf50-87122f7b90d3>.

Monitoring plan for HLOs and outcomes

The Multifunctional Landscapes program MELIA system focuses on performance monitoring, evaluation and reporting, as well as answering evaluation questions on the contribution to thriving multifunctional landscapes of agroecological, nature positive and nutrition-sensitive bundles of solutions and innovations, supported by inclusive governance, market and non-market mechanisms and incentives, and policy that are evidence-informed and learning-oriented.

The monitoring system implemented is learning-oriented and focused on infusing management decisions at AoW and program level with monitoring results, in a results-based management approach. The system is aligned with the CGIAR's Performance and Results Management Framework

(PRMF). Systematic documentation of actor engagement, progress on envisioned and emerging outcomes, and quality of partnerships, supported by monitoring of the HLOs contribution to these processes, will allow evidence-driven reporting and management.

The MELIA team will progressively integrate machine learning techniques into its data processes to enhance its analytical capabilities. These methods will help identify patterns in complex datasets, improve predictive analysis for landscape-level decision-making, and increase the efficiency of data quality checks. We will apply both supervised and unsupervised models to detect trends in adoption behavior, cluster stakeholder engagement profiles, and forecast potential risks to program implementation. This application of machine learning aligns with the program's vision of utilizing innovation for adaptive management and scalable impact.

The monitoring system for **HLOs and Outcomes** will be based on the following components (see Evaluation and Impact Assessment sections for Evaluation and Impacts):

1. **Monitoring performance indicators on HLOs targets: Output Tracker** adapted to information required by PRMS (once PRMS fully set up)
 - Objective: monitor to which extent the Multifunctional Landscapes Program delivers on outputs aligned with the levels of the AoWs: knowledge, capacity, innovations.
 - Frequency: Data collection will be carried out by MELIA friends (country focal points) quarterly and followed by data quality assurance and systematization.
2. **Monitoring performance indicators on Outcomes (AoW, Program level): Actor engagement and Outcome Journal**
 - Objective: monitor the progress towards changes in behavior targeted in the Program ToC as well as unintended or unexpected outcomes emerging during implementation.
 - Frequency: Data collection will be carried out on the go by MELIA friends (country focal points) and MELIA core team and followed by biannually data quality assurance and systematization.

Adapting the tool developed in the Agroecology Initiative (<https://hdl.handle.net/10568/169475>) actor engagement and progress on outcome indicators will be **monitored against agroecology and nature positive principles**, targeting the following domains:

- Agricultural practices: e.g. changes in terms of adoption or adaptation of agronomic practices.
- Environmental practices: e.g. changes in conservation and restoration practices.
- Social practices: e.g. changes in interactions, changes in participation of marginalized groups in community activities, inclusiveness in governance, markets, policies.
- Organizational practices: e.g. functional new producer-consumer organizations, participation of youth in producer organizations governance.
- Market practices: e.g. implementation of new businesses, changes in the type of people employed, changes in marketing approaches.

- Governance practices: e.g. changes in decision-making processes.
- Policy practices: e.g., changes in policy planning, content.

3. **Performance indicators on Partnerships: Quality of partnerships tool**

- **Objective:** monitor the evolution and quality of partnerships developed by the Multifunctional Landscapes program to inform and steer partner engagement and improve partnerships quality over the implementation of the program. Partnerships are a fundamental element of agroecological and nature positive approaches. Evaluating the quality of partnerships at key moments during the program life cycle will allow improved coordination, communication and scalability of program results. The Evaluation of Partnerships in CGIAR reports will guide framing of the strategy to evaluate partnerships in Multifunctional Landscapes.
- **Frequency:** Yearly. A baseline of partner capacity related to AoWs and quality of partnerships will be developed and yearly follow up implemented via key partner interviews following an evaluation grid.

4. **Bilaterals:**

- **Objective:** assessing the contribution of bilateral projects to Program Outcomes, as well as integrating results from bilaterals' MELIA studies (when available).
- **Frequency:** Yearly, data collected by core MELIA team linked to output tracking and outcome journals.

MELIA Team

The MELIA team, distributed across Centers, with global and country level focal points, is made up of researchers and MELIA experts who are also engaged in the AoW, which makes cross-fertilization between research activities and MELIA activities easier and systematic. The **MELIA team** includes:

- 1 MELIA **focal point** for program level MELIA leadership: Genowefa Blundo (Alliance Bioversity CIAT).
- 8 MELIA **experts** for MELIA set up, recommendations, analysis and use of MELIA results: Cargele Masso (ILRI), Carlo Azzarri (IFPRI), Carolina Gonzalez (Alliance Bioversity CIAT), Cristiano Rossignoli (Worldfish), Eleonora de Falcis (Alliance Bioversity CIAT), Guillermo Orjuela (Alliance Bioversity CIAT), Maria Jose Estupinan (Alliance Bioversity CIAT), Rose Chesoli (ILRI), Simone Staiger (Alliance Bioversity CIAT).
- 8 MELIA **friends** as country focal points to support set up, feeding data, and organizing MELIA activities at the country level: Dorcas Matangi (CIMMYT - Zimbabwe), Gulshan Borah (IWMI – India), Jose Sanchez Choy (Alliance Bioversity CIAT – Peru), Maria Jose Estupinan (Alliance Bioversity CIAT - Colombia), Rose Chesoli (ILRI - Tanzania), Zied Idoudi (ICARDA – Tunisia), TBC (Cirad – Senegal), TBC (Alliance Bioversity CIAT – Kenya).

Quality assurance

To ensure data quality and reliability, the MELIA framework incorporates systematic quality assurance processes across all tools. For the output tracker, data is reviewed periodically for consistency, completeness, and alignment with predefined indicators. In the actor engagement and outcome tracker, triangulation between data sources will allow checking the information recorded by comparing it with feedback from stakeholders and actual evidence from the field. This will help ensure that the findings are accurate and truly reflect what happened during the project. For the quality of partnership assessment, regular validation meetings will be held with partners to ensure accuracy and shared interpretation. Across all tools, data will be subject to internal review and version control protocols to ensure transparency.

Additionally, the Pause and Reflect workshops at the country level will provide a privileged space to present monitoring and evaluation results to local partners and stakeholders and obtain their feedback and perspective on the results being achieved and reported.

Finally, outcome evaluations will integrate participatory processes for outcome identification as well as for validation of the interpretation of results, as a core principle of the utilization-focused outcome evaluation approaches we will implement is that key partners and stakeholders engage at least in the identification and interpretation of the evaluation results in order to foster use of evaluation findings.

Contingency plans

The main risk of the monitoring system deployed is the reduction in human and financial resources available for carrying out monitoring, formative and summative evaluations. Globally, monitoring and evaluation risks will be mitigated by the distributed effort on MELIA among centers who are leading the Program's work in each landscape. This allows the MELIA system to function through a concerted effort among centers rather than centralizing all resources.

The risk mitigation strategy will first rely on refocusing monitoring and evaluation on so-called flagship countries, where the program will invest more resources (directly or through bilaterals) and therefore where there will be higher likelihood of evaluating the outcomes and associated assumptions. A subsequent risk mitigation strategy will be to refocus the monitoring and evaluation system on Intermediary Outcomes (I-OC) and 2030 Program outcomes, prioritizing few key AoW-IOC in order to reduce resource dispersion.

A more fundamental risk related to the nature of the work of the Program is the risk of conflict around priority action between science teams and the local landscape partnerships because of potentially diverging perspectives on priorities and outcomes. The Pause and Reflect workshop at the country level, are one of the tools to provide regular sharing of research findings with the landscape partnerships and solicit their interpretation of results. Moreover, feedback loops are also part of the revised Vision to Action plan that will be implemented in AoW2, but also of the type of multistakeholder engagement and capacity strengthening processes that the Program is engaging in throughout all its AoW.

Data collection strategy

To ensure robust monitoring and evaluation aligned with the CGIAR Performance and Results Management Framework, the following strategy outlines the processes for collecting, managing, and assuring the quality of data related to High-Level Outcomes (HLOs) and outcome indicators.

- **Roles and Responsibilities:** the MELIA team is responsible for tracking indicators. Their tasks include data collection, validation, analysis, and reporting.
- **Frequency of Data Collection:** Data collection begins with the establishment of baselines for each indicator. Subsequent data gathering is conducted at regular intervals, such as quarterly or annually, to monitor progress and support adaptive management.
- **Methods and Tools:** Standardized tools and templates will be used to ensure consistency across data collection activities.
- **Quality Assurance:** To ensure data reliability, a quality assurance process is applied. This includes data verification, where entries are cross-checked against source documents and field reports.

In alignment with CGIAR's Open Access and Open Data (OA-OD) FAIR Policy, data management practices aim to ensure that data is Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, and Reusable. While data collection and processing are handled by the Centers implementing the activities, all CGIAR Centers have endorsed the OA-OD Policy. This shared commitment ensures a reasonable level of harmonization and coherence across data-related processes at the Program level, promoting transparency, usability, and alignment with international standards.

Real-time results dashboard

An adapted digital platform will centralize output and outcome data, will highlight lessons learned and achievements, guiding decision-making processes. The MELIA team will provide regular reports to highlight lessons learned and guide evidence-based decision-making (Learning). This will be linked to the CGIAR PRMS dashboard.

Evaluation plan

The Evaluation plan of the Multifunctional Landscapes Program relies on different tools and approaches with a mixed-methods logic, for providing the most credible and robust evidence on the outcomes and impacts that the Program will contribute to generate over time.

The plan implements formative and summative evaluations to assess progress on the indicators targeted in the ToC, actively involving stakeholders throughout the evaluation process (yearly Pause and Reflect workshops at country level and System Level Theory of Change studies) to ensure engagement, relevance and use of the results. It also provides impact assessment studies answering key evaluation questions about which outcomes and impacts have been achieved, for whom, how, and under what conditions.

Formative and summative evaluation activities will focus on the qualification of the monitoring results related to the activities or projects that fall under the different AoWs and will consider the articulation between them.

Evaluation results will integrate relevant results from AoW6 evidence generation and AoW7 learning, as well as those coming on specific assessments from AoW1, 2, 3, 4, and 5. Evaluation will provide a bridge between monitoring and learning for effective adaptation of Program implementation.

Key evaluation questions linked to the Program’s assumptions and research questions:

The program’s overall assumption is that:

“By collaboratively designing nutrition-sensitive solutions rooted in agroecological, nature-positive, regenerative, conservation, and restoration principles —supported by inclusive business models, enabling governance, coherent policies, and grounded in evidence and continuous learning— and implementing these solutions in priority ecosystems through integrated landscape approaches guided by agroecological principles geared towards nature-positive outcomes, it is possible to help realize healthier and more nutritious food systems, foster resilient and equitable livelihoods, and enhance biodiversity and ecosystem gains”.

The evaluation plan will unpack this assumption to answer the following major evaluation questions (see also Impact Assessment section):

- Under what conditions and through which mechanisms agroecological and nature positive approaches, within a multifunctional landscape lens, optimize landscape multifunctionality?
- What are the behavioral outcomes of such a multifunctional landscapes approach? For whom? Under what conditions?

The following MELIA studies will allow us to answer these questions through multiple analysis angles.

System Based Theory of Change: in order to analyze how the changes at the landscape level influenced by the Program will generate changes at the country level and be influenced by changes at the country level, we will implement System Based Theory of Change methodology developed by Worldfish (see references in the Evidence Base section under Impact Assessment). We will engage relevant landscape stakeholders in pilot landscapes (e.g. Peru, Kenya, Tunisia, India) in 2025/2026 to identify potential impacts at the national level (nodal points of change) and then re-evaluate in 2028 (mid-term) and 2030 (final evaluation) how these evolved and what was the contribution of the Multifunctional Landscapes Program interventions to these changes. This will allow us to identify the most impactful Outcomes related to the Impact Areas and orient Outcome Evidencing studies for efficient use of MELIA resources.

Outcome Evaluations: Through Outcome Evidencing/Outcome Trajectory Evaluation, we will evaluate behavioral changes and the historical trajectories leading to them for key landscape actors.

We will prioritize countries where these outcome evaluations based on the most successful pathways of change as monitored through Outcome Journals and Program learning Reviews. However, some countries could be pre-identified such as Colombia, Peru, Tunisia, Kenya, India and Vietnam, which ensure regional diversity, have HR available for outcome and impact assessment, and have baselines availability. For Peru, Colombia and Kenya, outcome evidencing studies already provide a baseline for the key behavioral outcomes that were emerging through the AE Initiative work (see bibliographic references in the Evidence Base section under Impact Assessment). These studies will allow us to look at pathways of change influenced by inclusive land use planning and governance, as well as inclusive market, non-market, financial, and policy mechanisms.

Policy change analysis: Tracing influence on policy processes at multiple scales through analysis of governance and policy documents influenced by the research of the science program. However, the specific interventions assessed cannot be defined at this stage as the program is based on highly contextualized and co-design interventions that will be defined in the first year of implementation.

Adoption studies: In 2025, we analyze the farm household level baselines carried out during the Agroecology and Nature Positive initiatives in Colombia, Peru, Tunisia, Kenya and Vietnam (see references in the Evidence Base section under Impact Assessment) to assess their comparability. The first research output of the MELIA team will be a comparative analysis of these baselines in terms of agroecology and nature positive practices in the five landscapes targeted. These are baselines that will allow us to look at adoption (and eventually impacts) of agroecological and nature positive practices (mainly linked to AoW1 and AoW3 for business models).

Causal Impact Assessment: Based on the targeting of farmer household intervened, the quantitative baselines in Colombia, Peru, Kenya, Tunisia and Vietnam can be used for counterfactual quasi-experimental studies to assess impacts of selected agroecology and nature positive solutions on productivity, income and food security by applying Differences in Differences analysis combined with Propensity Score matching for robust counterfactual identification.

In-depth case studies in Peru, Colombia, Kenya, Tunisia, Vietnam, and India will allow us to draw comparative insights on these two questions and develop the basis for a middle-range theory on how agroecological and nature positive approaches implemented in a multifunctional landscape lens generate behavioral outcomes and optimize landscape multifunctionality. The in-depth case studies will also be complemented by the systematic monitoring of outcomes and outcome generating processes in all targeted sites and will leverage on the performance assessment studies carried out in AoW6, allowing us to draw conclusions that go beyond the specificities of selected sites.

The full MELIA study template is available in the Results Framework attached in the folder and in Annex 2.

Evaluation collaboration plans

Collaboration discussions on key evaluation pathways have started with the Climate Action and Better Diets and Nutrition Programs. Collaborations with Sustainable Farming and Sustainable Animal and Aquatic Foods will be further engaged.

Collaboration in evaluation will be in particular linked to the following outcomes from these Programs:

SP05 - Better Diets and Nutrition	SP06 - Climate Action	SP03 - Sustainable Animal and Aquatic Foods	SP02 - Sustainable Farming
Food traders, processors, and/or retailers adopt effective components of bundled solutions to reduce food loss and waste	1 Small-scale producers and other food, land, and water (FLW) system actors — including women, youth, and marginalized groups — use climate advisory services, early warning systems, or adaptive safety nets to manage climate risks and adopt new practices and benefitting from deep engagement models that result in demonstrable changes in behavior, improved resilience, and generates co-benefits on food security and poverty reduction. 4 Producers and other food, land, water system actors adopt locally-led adaptation solutions 8 Government, development partners and the private sector actors mobilize financing to support low-emissions development informed by CG science and evidence	PO3 - Communities within animal and aquatic food systems adopt innovations for increased social, economic and environmental resilience PO5 - Market actors, including women, youth and marginalized groups invest in market systems innovations for equitable, efficient, low-emission and resilient animal and aquatic food systems	1 Farmers have adopted inclusive adaptation and mitigation solutions into their farming practices enhancing their resilience and contributing to a reduction in GHG emissions per unit of production area 3. Farmers, farmer organizations and stakeholders scale soil health management solutions informed by the evidence generated within the soil health monitoring framework to ultimately reverse land degradation and enhance ecosystem services including carbon sequestration, hydrological function, above and below ground biodiversity and productivity 5a. Farmers adopt water innovations to reduce water-related risks to agronomic gain 7 Small and medium-scale farmers adopt and benefit from bundles of farm system innovations from which particularly women, youth, or other disadvantaged groups will benefit.

As part of our MELIA work, we conducted a mapping exercise to identify how each bilateral's MEL strategy contributes to the MELIA studies under the Multifunctional Landscapes SP. This alignment exercise allows us to visualize synergies, ensure complementarity, and enhance the relevance and coverage of the MELIA studies. The first mapping focused on the 12 bilaterals that strongly align to the Program's outputs and outcomes. MEL plans for bilaterally funded projects will be further mapped throughout 2025 to the Program intermediate and 2030 outcomes in coordination with project managers.

As of May 2025, 7 bilaterals' documents clearly present their MELIA strategy. All of them have been mapped to our MELIA studies, as shown in the following table.

Bilateral	Contribution to Multifunctional Landscapes MELIA Studies
UK FCDO - Seed to tree: value chains and partnerships for resilient restored forests in Malaysia	• Actor engagement and outcome tracking
UK – GCBC (UK-Defra) - Deploying Diversity as a Strategic Asset for Scaling of Ethiopia's Green Legacy Initiative for Climate Change Resilience and Livelihoods	• Program learning review • Actor engagement and outcome tracking
FRANCE – FFEM Promover Oportunidades Sostenibles en la Cadena de Valor del Cacao de Excelencia (IA Lead of A1537)	• Actor engagement and outcome tracking
CoIMPACT INDIA	• Program learning review
Fruitful Lands India Phase II	• Actor engagement and outcome tracking
Sustainable Investments for Large-scale Rangeland R	• Actor engagement and outcome tracking
Building Community Resilience by Alleviating Water scarcity and Land Degradation through Integrated Natural Resource Management in Bundelkhand, Uttar Pradesh	• Actor engagement and outcome tracking

National partners will be engaged in the Outcome Evidencing and System Level Theory of Change studies, as well as local consultants. Quantitative adoption and causal impact assessment studies will be carried out with the collaboration of survey firms for data collection.

Impact assessment

The effects of Multifunctional Landscape approaches and innovations occurring at different levels of intervention (farmers, organizations, communities, markets, policies) call for a **differentiated Impact Assessment (IA) strategy that employs quantitative and qualitative methods** to measure the **contribution** of the **Multifunctional Landscapes Program to long-term impacts**, as well as to assess the **mechanisms** specific to the **Multifunctional Landscape approach** that allow outcomes and impacts to be achieved, following the logic (ToC) of the Program, from prioritizing and bundling co-designed solutions and innovations, supported by inclusive land use planning and governance, inclusive business models and market and financial mechanisms, and inclusive and coherent policies, to their uptake at scale informed by evidence, learning and capacity strengthening processes at multiple levels and for diverse landscape stakeholders, according to their needs and vision.

Our IA framework has two research components:

1. **Analyze the processes underlying behavior change at multiple decision-making levels relevant to the landscape, deepening the understanding of landscape change processes, following the Program ToC:**

Through selected in-depth case studies, we will **assess assumptions on the co-design mechanisms** underlying adoption of bundles of innovations and solutions that optimize landscape multifunctionality and the role of inclusive governance, market and non-market incentives and policy play in this process.

The key impact evaluation questions addressed in this component are:

- To what extent do multistakeholder engagement processes and co-design of science-based processes and tools lead to ownership of results by landscape stakeholders and to the sustainable uptake of solutions?
- Through which mechanisms does the multidisciplinary and transdisciplinary science promoted by the Multifunctional Landscapes program generate adoption of bundles of solutions and innovations at the landscape level?
- Under what conditions and through which mechanisms agroecological and nature positive approaches, within a multifunctional landscape lens, optimize landscape multifunctionality?
- What are the behavioral outcomes of such a multifunctional landscapes approach? For whom? Under what conditions?

Behavior change studies are indispensable in understanding and addressing the human dimensions of agroecological transitions. By integrating socio-cultural, economic, and institutional insights, these studies ensure that interventions are not only scientifically robust but also socially acceptable and economically viable.

Without excluding the analysis of other outcome generating processes, we will provide particular attention to the following **outcome generating processes underlying the Program ToC**:

- Multistakeholder involvement and co-design at different stages of collaborative research.
- Socially inclusive and adaptive multistakeholder decision-making, landscape governance, and land-use planning.
- Socially inclusive and gender-transformative processes.
- National, subnational, and regional landscape-level policies, strategies, programs, and investments.
- Global and regional agenda-setting on environmental health and biodiversity.

2. Assess adoption and impact of selected bundles of solutions and innovations, and under what conditions these impacts are achieved:

Taking advantage of the baselines collected during the Agroecology and Nature Positive Initiatives (Peru, Colombia, Tunisia, Kenya, Vietnam) we will quantitatively assess **the assumptions about the adoption of bundles of agroecological and nature positive solutions and innovations** (or their bundles) at the farmer level and the impacts they generated in key impact dimensions (e.g. socio-economic impacts, food security):

- Under what conditions and through which mechanisms agroecological and nature positive solutions optimize landscape multifunctionality?

- To what extent do multistakeholder engagement processes and co-design of science-based processes and tools lead to ownership of results by landscape stakeholders and to the sustainable uptake of solutions?
- Under what conditions are agroecological and nature positive bundles of solutions adopted at the farmer level?
- (If feasible) To what extent do these bundles of solutions generate economic and nutrition impacts?

The diversity of landscapes addressed in the Multifunctional Landscapes Program will provide enriching contrasts to the evaluation methods, allowing us to compare results across key outcomes and impacts, and acknowledge the need for contextualized and appropriate approaches, only partially standardized to allow comparison across key indicators.

A fundamental methodological research question underlines Impact Assessment activities of the Multifunctional Landscapes program:

- How can the impact of multifunctional landscape approaches be meaningfully defined?
- What are the appropriate methodological choices to assess in a robust, adequate and meaningful way the impacts of systemic and complex multifunctional landscape approaches?

This question acknowledges the methodology and data gaps for targeting and linking farm-level and landscape-level measures, and will be answered in close collaboration with AoW6, where appropriate metrics and performance assessment frameworks will be designed and analyzed.

Program/Accelerator impact overview

The Program's overall assumption, as recalled above, is that:

“By collaboratively designing nutrition-sensitive solutions rooted in agroecological, nature-positive, regenerative, conservation, and restoration principles —supported by inclusive business models, enabling governance, coherent policies, and grounded in evidence and continuous learning— and implementing these solutions in priority ecosystems through integrated landscape approaches guided by agroecological principles geared towards nature-positive outcomes, it is possible to help realize healthier and more nutritious food systems, foster resilient and equitable livelihoods, and enhance biodiversity and ecosystem gains”.

Through the outcome and impact generation mechanisms outlined in the ToC Narrative section above, the portfolio aims to contribute to all 5 impact areas at the portfolio level (see Results Framework), by significantly reducing GHG emission by restoring 4 million hectares of degraded land and 1 million hectares of inland water systems, integrating landscape multifunctionality and indicators into national and sub-national biodiversity strategies, adaptation plans, land degradation neutrality targets, and other relevant policies in at least 50% of targeted countries, as well as in

financing agencies for development projects, to target country commitments and negotiating for carbon finance and other mechanisms.

The Program, through the bundles of solutions and innovations supported by inclusive and evidence-informed land and resource use planning, business models and policies, aims to achieve conservation and sustainable use of over 98% of current agrobiodiversity and 8 million ha in the targeted landscapes, including peatlands, rangelands, forests, and protected areas. The solutions also aim to improve water use efficiency by 20% in irrigated farming systems and reduced economic water scarcity by 25% in at least one-third of targeted landscapes, while protecting and restoring at least 20% of inland water systems in at least 5 countries. Underlined by the focus on GEYSI responsive and transformative approaches, the Program aims to enhance inclusivity in governance, with decision-making bodies including at least 35% women, in addition to youth, indigenous people, local communities, and other often-marginalized groups, as well as supporting decent employment through cascading effects on the landscapes targeted and the country for 500.000 youth. By engaging with other CGIAR Programs and Accelerators and with strong support from Scaling for Impact, but also through supporting bilaterals, the Program targets to reach 6 million farmers with tailored bundled solutions that attain stable production and nutrition goals, improving food and nutrition security for 20 million people in the targeted landscapes by 2030. The scaling capacity of the Program will strongly be supported by the co-design, capacity strengthening and collective action processes that the Program relies on, which will allow engaged partners and landscape stakeholders to take the Program's results at scale.

IA activities and collaboration plans

Our **IA framework** includes a combination of studies at different levels of analysis (from farmer to national level) and to assess different assumptions on how impacts are generated through Multifunctional Landscapes approaches based on co-design and systemic thinking.

The specific methodologies used include quantitative counterfactual analysis for adoption and impact measurement (where feasible, as well as evaluation methods that allow to capture multidimensional, unintended and unexpected consequences.

Given the complexity and breath of the impacts that the Program aims to influence, impact studies will be targeted to the key areas of success of the Program and will therefore be defined by:

- Availability of baselines from the three Initiatives
- The results of monitoring and evaluation that will provide guidance on the key Outcomes achieved
- The collaboration with other Programs/Accelerators
- The studies developed in bilaterals mapped to specific outcomes of the Program

Impact assessment efforts at the **behavioral change** level will focus on the **2030 Program Outcomes** but also on **unintended or unexpected significant outcomes** highlighted through mid-term and final Outcome Evaluations and Policy change analyses (see Evaluation section).

Data on behavioral changes will be monitored yearly through **participatory outcome identification workshops with all partners engaged at the country/site level** and **outcome journals** (see monitoring section). These yearly workshops at the country/site level are budgeted on the 20% non-assigned budget per center and have already been set aside by centers.

The System Based Theory of Change approach will be applied to identify areas of success and prioritize the Outcome Evaluations (see Evaluation section).

This IA framework has strong links to the AoW6 evidence generation efforts, as well as specific assessment results from AoW1, 2, 3, 4, and 5, including in particular:

- Assessment of how circular capacities are integrated and measured in regenerative landscape systems (AoW6)
- Results from the Evidence Hub for harmonization and easy exploration of evidence of agroecology performance (ERA, AE-I, N+, Stats4SD, FAO) (AoW6)
- Contextualized assessment frameworks on key KPIs in each landscape (AoW6)
- Political economy analysis of landscape policy processes (AoW4)
- Ex-ante trade-off policy analyses (AoW4)
- Adoption and cost-benefit assessments for inclusive business models and financial mechanisms (AoW3)
- Evidence generation on GEYSI responsive and transformative approaches (AoW5)

As discussed in the Evaluation section, collaboration discussions on key evaluation pathways have started with the Climate Action and Better Diets and Nutrition Programs. Collaborations with Sustainable Farming and Sustainable Animal and Aquatic Foods will be further engaged.

Evidence Base

The IA framework relies on previous evaluations carried out during the Initiatives:

- Outcome evaluations:
 - "Outcome evaluations carried out during the initiatives:
 - Blundo Canto, G.; Owino, E.; Nekoye, H. (2024) Kiambu ALL Outcome Evidencing Report. 39 p. <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/169711>
 - Mouna, M.; Blundo Canto, G.M. (2024) Kef-Siliana ALL Outcome Evidencing Report. 45 p. <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/169706>
 - Ortiz, D.; Blundo Canto, G.; Orjuela, G. (2024) Ucayali outcome evidencing report. 42 p. <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/170005>
 - CGIAR Initiative on Livestock and Climate (2025) Technologies in a Social Context. Results Factsheet 1. Nairobi, Kenya: International Livestock Research Institute."

- Policy tracing:
 - Hassen Ouerghemmi, Aymen Fria, Ali M. Oumer, Boubaker Dhehibi, Nehring Ryan. (26/10/2023). Mapping Policy Actors for Enhanced Engagement Towards Agroecology Transition: Case of Tunisia. Beirut, Lebanon: International Center for Agricultural Research in the Dry Areas (ICARDA).
 - Place, Frank. 2023. Agroecology Initiative policy tracker guideline and tool. CGIAR System Organization.
 - Singh, Sonali; and Maliappan, Sudarshan. 2024. Baseline review of policies in India: Understanding the policy context for facilitating agroecological transition. Agroecology Initiative Brief January 2024. CGIAR System Organization. <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/139549>
 - Chiduwa, M. S., Marenja, P. P., Ngoma, H., Nohayi., Ngowenani., & Chimonyo, V. G. P. (2023). Assessing the opportunities for agroecological transition in Zimbabwe: A review current policies. CGIAR.
 - Arce, A.; Ivanova, Y.; Tristan Febres, M.C.; Pareja, P. (2023) WP4 - Peru: Synthesis of policies and institutions toward an agroecological transition. 18 p.
 - Otieno, G.; Sikinyi, E.; Vernooy, R.; Fadda, C.; Halewood, M. (2023) How policies influence smallholder farmers' access to and use of genetic resources in three East African countries. Rome (Italy): Bioversity International 48 p. ISBN: 978-92-9255-276-3
 - Otieno, K.P. 2024. A National Land Policy Review in Kenya: Rangelands and Pastoralists' Perspective. Nairobi, Kenya: ILRI.
- Quantitative baseline studies:
 - Boukaka, Sedi-Anne; Azzarri, Carlo; Davis, Kristin E.; and De Falcis, Eleonora. 2024. Nature-Positive Solutions initiative baseline evaluation survey report: Kenya. CGIAR Initiative on Nature-Positive Solutions Survey Report July 2024. Washington, DC: International Food Policy Research Institute. <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/149119>
 - Boukaka, Sedi-Anne; Azzarri, Carlo; Davis, Kristin E.; and De Falcis, Eleonora. 2024. Nature-Positive Solutions initiative baseline evaluation survey report: Vietnam. CGIAR Initiative on Nature-Positive Solutions Survey Report July 2024. Washington, DC: International Food Policy Research Institute. <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/149125>
 - Lopera, Diana Carolina; Ordoñez, Juan Camilo; Azzarri, Carlo; Davis, Kristin E.; and De Falcis, Eleonora. 2024. Nature-Positive Solutions Initiative survey report: Colombia. Washington, DC and Rome, Italy: International Food Policy Research Institute and Alliance Bioversity and CIAT. <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/172753>
 - Orjuela Ramirez, G.; López-Estrada, S. (2024) Efficiency of agroecological practices in cacao production in Ucayali, Peru. 5 p. <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/169218>

In addition to the specific evaluation studies carried out during the initiative, the design of Outcome Evaluations, Adoption and Causal Impact Assessment studies will also review and rely on the evidence on the top 10 innovations uses the Program aims to scale:

- Sustainable waste recycling and alternative feed through community-Led Black Soldier Fly (BSF) farming in Kenya: <https://reporting.cgiar.org/reports/result-details/18316?phase=4>
- Value chains and business development for aggregated farms in Kenya: <https://reporting.cgiar.org/reports/result-details/12681?phase=4>
- Conservation of local crop and tree diversity for food and nutrition security, income generation, and climate change adaptation: <https://reporting.cgiar.org/reports/result-details/12451?phase=4>
- Resilient seed systems approach and methodology <https://reporting.cgiar.org/reports/result-details/3159>
- Improved governance, management and restoration for joint village land use planning, participatory rangeland management and restoration in Tanzania and Kenya: <https://reporting.cgiar.org/reports/result-details/20256>; <https://reporting.cgiar.org/reports/result-details/20257>
- Use of animal manure and other biofertilizers in Kenya, Burkina Faso and Senegal: <https://reporting.cgiar.org/reports/result-details/18130>
- Living Labs - An international community of research and development actors engaged in action-research, codesign and multistakeholder approaches to promote agroecological transitions: <https://reporting.cgiar.org/reports/result-details/17243>
- Feed pellet mechanized production based on locally available by products: <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/173132>
- Capacity strengthening of advisory services: <https://reporting.cgiar.org/reports/result-details/18088>

IA studies

The impact assessment strategy aims to gauge the outcomes of interventions in multifunctional landscapes at different levels, from farmers, to organizations, market systems, policies and global actors. This strategy also seeks a clear understanding of the mechanisms and reasons behind the impacts achieved under the main program assumption, as outlined in the MELIA plan.

The current funding landscape uncertainty as well as a realistic assessment of resources that can be dedicated to IA led us to prioritize IA activities in 6 countries, where we can easily leverage on human and financial resources for impact assessment: Colombia, Peru, Tunisia, Kenya, India, Vietnam. The site prioritization, as well as prioritization of the key impact indicators that the IA should target (potential indicators are presented in the table below), will be a specific action of the MELIA team at the end of 2025, when future financial capacity will be clearer. Further funding for IA studies will be sought in 2026 and during the implementation of the Program.

The table in the next page provides an overview of the studies that will allow us to answer impact assessment questions (outcomes and impacts).

Please refer to the MELIA studies table in Annex 2 for detail on outcomes, indicators and assumptions tested.

IA studies

Result Level	Countries	MELIA Study Type	Frequency	MELIA study and tools	Evaluation questions	Multifunctional Landscapes Results Dashboard Potential Indicators
Program 2030 Outcomes	Colombia, Peru, Tunisia, Kenya, India, Vietnam	Outcome Evaluation	Mid term (2028) Endline (2030)	Outcome Evidencing/ Outcome Trajectory evaluation instruments: Document review, workshops, key informant interviews, secondary data System-based Theory of Change Actor engagement and outcome tracker AoW6 assessments AoW7 partner capacity evaluation	- To what extent do multistakeholder engagement processes and co-design of science-based processes and tools lead to ownership of results by landscape stakeholders and therefore to the sustainable uptake of solutions? - Through which mechanisms does the multidisciplinary and transdisciplinary science promoted by the Multifunctional Landscapes program generate adoption of bundles of solutions and innovations at the landscape level? - What are the behavioral outcomes of such a multifunctional landscapes approach? For whom? Under what conditions?	- Number and type of landscape stakeholders applying solutions, innovations and science from Multifunctional Landscapes - Number and type of landscape stakeholders sharing capacities and knowledge - Number and type of landscape actors participating in governance, policy, market and non market incentives and innovations - Number and type of landscape stakeholders influencing agenda setting and policy discourse - Number of partners with increased capacity in multifunctional landscapes science, development and practice.
	Colombia, Peru, Tunisia, Kenya, Vietnam	Adoption studies	(Eventual) additional baselines (2026) Endline (2030)	Household Surveys AoW6 assessments	To what extent do multistakeholder engagement processes and co-design of science-based processes and tools lead to ownership of results by landscape stakeholders and therefore to the sustainable uptake of solutions?	Number of farmers adopting agroecology and nature-positive solutions
Program 2030 Outcomes related to Policy Intermediary Outcomes related to Policy	TBD	Policy change analysis	Mid term (2028) Endline (2030)	Documentary review System-based Theory of Change Actor engagement and outcome tracker	To what extent does co-design of science-based processes and tools lead to ownership of results by landscape stakeholders and therefore to the sustainable uptake of solutions?	Number of policy outputs and processes integrating Multifunctional Landscapes science and approaches
Impact Areas	Colombia, Peru, Tunisia, Kenya, Vietnam	Causal impact assessment	(Eventual) additional baselines (2026)	Quasi-experimental studies (Household Surveys)	To what extent do these bundles of solutions generate economic and nutrition impacts?	Number of people with improved food security (disaggregating youth, men, women etc)

Result Level	Countries	MELIA Study Type	Frequency	MELIA study and tools	Evaluation questions	Multifunctional Landscapes Results Dashboard Potential Indicators
			Endline (2030)	System-based Theory of Change AoW6 assessments		• Number of people benefitting economically (disaggregating youth, men, women etc) • Number of ha under improved management through agroecological, nature positive, regenerative agriculture management • Number of ha restored • Number of ha with increased agrobiodiversity • Number of ha under improved water use efficiency or reduced economic water scarcity
	Colombia, Peru, Tunisia, Kenya, Vietnam, India	Outcome Evaluation	Mid term (2028) Endline (2030)	Outcome Evidencing/ Outcome evaluation instruments: Document review, workshops, key informant interviews, secondary data System-based Theory of Change Actor engagement and outcome tracker AoW6 assessments AoW7 partner capacity evaluation	• To what extent does co-design of science-based processes and tools lead to ownership of results by landscape stakeholders and therefore to the sustainable uptake of solutions?	• Number and type of landscape stakeholders applying sustainable resource use and management • Number and type of landscape stakeholders implementing governance innovations • Number and type of landscape stakeholders implementing policy, market, non market, financial innovations and incentives • Number of landscape stakeholders empowered to act for sustained multifunctional landscapes

Learning and adaptive management

This MELIA component will support adaptive management through structured reflection on evaluation findings from the evaluation and impact assessment components, including through participatory processes. It will provide integration spaces to reflect on the learnings from the assessments implemented across the different Areas of Work. Adaptive management should be based on both operational process-related learning, making use of lessons as they arise, and research-based learning, making use of lessons in a periodic reflective process.

The Learning component will serve as a critical bridge between Monitoring & Evaluation activities and Impact Assessment, as well as to generate insights from evidence to support program steering. Learning will take place within the management teams (AoW), and partnership levels based on quantitative and qualitative data (on delivery of planned activities and outputs, but also on the next user's perceptions of co-creation processes, capacity sharing, and partnerships).

The learning component will:

- track delivery against targeted indicators and timelines
- document success stories as well as lessons learned on challenges
- after-action reviews and detailed case studies
- disseminate learning products
- facilitate knowledge sharing opportunities
- establish feedback mechanisms that integrate learning directly into program design

The program's knowledge management approach is grounded in the principles of collaborative research with partners and stakeholders, emphasizing co-creation, co-implementation, and co-evaluation. To support this, we commit to working in alignment with FAIR data principles, ensuring data is findable, accessible, interoperable, and reusable. This requires early and clear agreement with partners on data collection and analysis methods, including the integration of citizen science where relevant, and the establishment of shared online workspaces that are accessible to all collaborators.

A key feature of this approach will be the organization of annual "Pause and Reflect" workshops—both in-person and virtual—that bring together key partners to assess progress and guide learning. **Yearly Pause and Reflect Workshops at the country level and at the program level** will be the privileged spaces and moments of reflexivity and learning with landscape stakeholders and program partners. The integration of researchers from the MELIA team in particular in the Vision to Action process of landscape level action planning and systematic review, also provides a space for bridging learning from the landscape level to the Program level. **Yearly Program Learning Reviews with specific outputs (briefs, internal reports, scientific publications)** will be carried out after every reporting period following the CGIAR PRMS deadlines. These reviews will provide the PMU, Leadership Team and MELIA team specific spaces of learning on key challenges, opportunities and emerging outcomes that will infuse adaptive management.

These workshops will ensure strong linkages between Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (MEL) activities related to program performance, the quality of collaborative research, and the effectiveness of both technical and social innovations. This integrated assessment framework draws on insights from previous initiatives, which have shown that meaningful interconnection across assessment types is essential for sustaining co-developed solutions. However, achieving this integration requires intentional effort and coordination with partners and stakeholders.

The MELIA friends composing the MELIA team are researchers and MELIA experts engaged in the AoW: this will allow bridging learning actions to ensure that the performance of the AoW is analyzed at the country and AoW internal level whilst linking to the program objectives and ToC. Furthermore, we will actively involve partners in data analysis processes and jointly plan scientific publications and communication outputs from the outset. This includes not only peer-reviewed papers but also policy briefs, blogs, social media content, and videos co-authored with partners to ensure broad and inclusive dissemination of findings and learnings.

Reporting

The MELIA team for the SP will develop internal reporting system that allow to capture outputs and outcomes real-time, based on an Output Tracker and an Actor Engagement and Outcome Journal, currently under development.

These two tools will be filled on the go by the team of MELIA friends for reporting at the country level, and by AoW leads/co-leads for what concerns activities not specific to the country sites.

We will follow recommendations from the CGIAR Technical Reporting Arrangement (TRA) 2025–30 and input all required reporting information in the PRMS.

MELIA resources

The MELIA resources are centralized in the cross-cutting budget for what concerns MELIA studies, whilst they are distributed among centers for what concerns monitoring activities.

However, the yearly estimated budget is 140k USD in staff time and 50k USD in operations (for Pause and reflect workshops and travelling). The staff time includes about 30% of time of the MELIA focal point, 30% of time of a post-doctoral researcher, 60% of time of a research assistant, and about 15% of time for the 8 MELIA focal points at the country level.

The provisional budget for years in which assessments are carried out is: 50k in 2028 for outcome evidencing; 250k in 2030 for outcome evidencing and adoption/ia studies.

Therefore, the MELIA budget for 2025 is 140k in staff time and 50k in operations.

Activity title	Activity description	2025–2030 Total cost (USD)					
		2025 (Budget)	2026 (Forecast)	2027 (Forecast)	2028 (Forecast)	2029 (Forecast)	2030 (Forecast)
1. Monitoring activities: Cross-cutting							
Activities related to the routine monitoring of HLOs and outcomes							
Output tracking, Actor engagement and Outcome journals, Policy tracing, Program Learning Reviews, Outcome Evidencing, Adoption Studies, Causal IA	Staff time MELIA focal points and researchers	140.000	140.000	140.000	140.000	140.000	140.000
Pause and reflect workshops at country level/ System-based Theory of Change	Travelling and workshop expenses	50.000	50.000	50.000	50.000	50.000	50.000
Results dashboard	Staff time IT person	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD	TBD
2. MELIA studies: Cross-cutting							

Activity title	Activity description	2025–2030 Total cost (USD)					
		2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
		(Budget)	(Forecast)	(Forecast)	(Forecast)	(Forecast)	(Forecast)
MELIA studies to evidence the achievement of program-level impacts and outcomes							
Outcome evidencing	Data collection and analysis				60.000		60.000
Adoption/impact assessment studies	Data collection and analysis		TBD				200.000
Policy change analyses					TBD	TBD	TBD
Sub-total: Cross-cutting MELIA costs							
3. MELIA studies: AoW outcomes							
MELIA studies to evidence the achievement of AoW-level intermediate outcomes not covered by any cross-cutting MELIA studies							
Sub-total: Other MELIA costs							
TOTAL: All MELIA costs		190.000	190.000	190.000	250.000	190.000	450.000

Data management

A **data management plan and system** will be set up, including data quality assurance, validation processes, verification and triangulation, and the preparation of periodic monitoring reports.

The MELIA team will work closely with country teams and partners to support monitoring and reporting, including through targeted training.

Monitoring data collection will be implemented by **MELIA Friends** from each country team, meaning center staff located in the country or staff from partner institutes leading the implementation of the activities in the sites. They will have a clear deliverable and allocated budget/staff time for reporting on the indicators identified with the MELIA team. Standardized data collection tools and processes, and data management plan templates will be developed with/provided to the MELIA Friends.

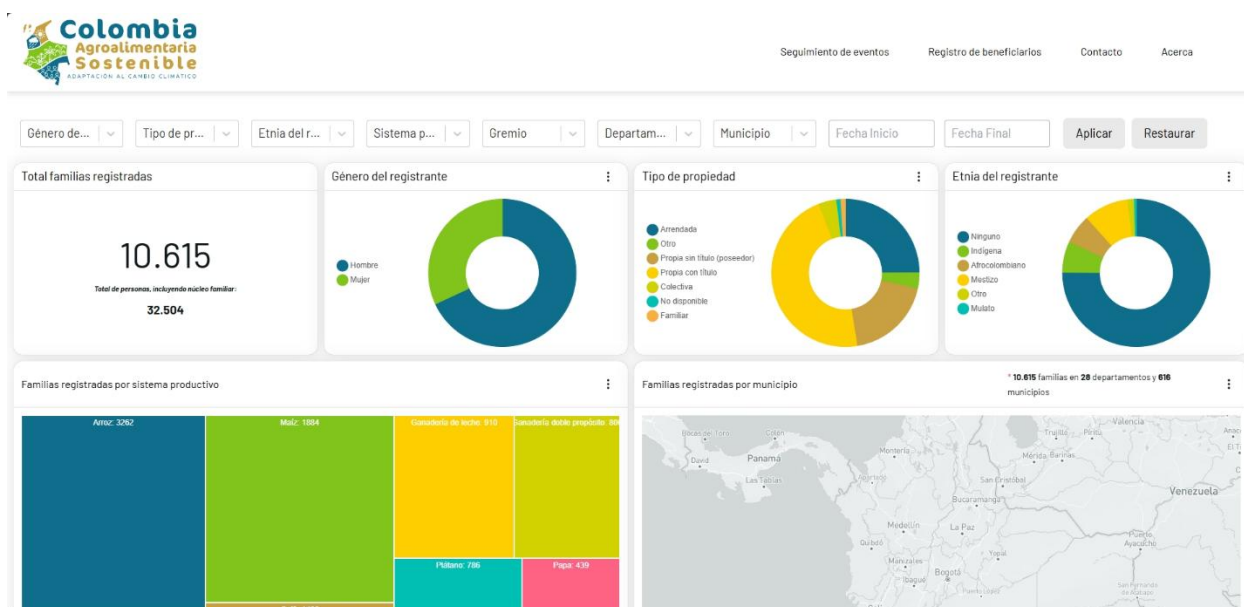
To achieve integration and reduce the burden on the teams, MELIA indicators that the MELIA Friends will collect will also respond to the needs of selected AoWs, in particular AoW5 and AoW6, in order to integrate gender indicators and other performance indicators relevant to these AoWs.

Multiple datasets will be generated from farmer household surveys but also through the actor engagement and outcome tracking tool.

All outputs generated through the Multifunctional Landscapes Science Program—including reports, data sets, tools, and other knowledge products—will be uploaded to CGSpace, the official open-access repository of CGIAR. This ensures compliance with CGIAR's Open Access and Open Data (OA-OD) Policy and guarantees that program-related outputs are findable, accessible, interoperable, and reusable (FAIR). Publishing on CGSpace promotes transparency, facilitates knowledge sharing, and supports accountability to stakeholders and donors.

Results Dashboards

The MELIA team will take advantage of the existence of a dedicated dashboard that allows real-time follow up that can easily be updated to the Multifunctional Landscapes SP needs and linked to the CGIAR Program Results Dashboard. For this purpose, a dashboard hosted by the Alliance Bioversity CIAT will be adapted to the needs of the Multifunctional Landscapes SP to provide real time overview of key MELIA indicators: [Colombia Agroalimentaria Sostenible](#).



This dashboard—*Colombia Agroalimentaria Sostenible*—is an interactive tool designed to visualize and analyze data on producer families participating in sustainable agri-food systems. It features a variety of filters that allow users to disaggregate data by gender, property type, ethnicity, production system, producer organization, and geographic location (department and municipality). These filters help tailor the data view to specific MELIA questions and indicators.

The dashboard presents updated summaries—including the total number of registered families, their distribution by gender and ethnic groups, the types of productive systems in use, and their geographic coverage. This enables stakeholders to monitor progress, identify trends, and make evidence-based decisions. The data is refreshed every 24 hours to ensure timely and accurate information.

Developed with support from strategic partners in Colombia such as AGROSAVIA, CENICAFÉ, and FEDEARROZ, the dashboard contributes to strengthening inclusive monitoring practices within Colombia's sustainable food systems.

The results from MELIA will also be integrated in communication-oriented dashboards adopted by AoW6, such as the TRANSITIONS Metrics Library ([TRANSITIONS-Metrics-Library.pdf](#)), and AoW7. Results from the Multifunctional Landscapes MELIA dashboard will feed into the CGIAR dashboard.

Annex 2. MELIA studies template

MELIA Study title	MELIA type	Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Country	Methods and design approaches	Start date for the study	End date for the study	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
Actor engagement and outcome tracking	Program/project evaluation or review	- Intermediate Outcome - I-OC 3. Producer organizations, national and sub-national public actors, private sector actors, and finance actors use the co-created knowledge and consumer preferences to implement inclusive business models and innovative financing mechanisms - Intermediate Outcome - I-OC4 National governments, subnational and local policy actors use evidence - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 5.2. National and sub-national public actors, private sector and finance actors integrate social incentives and behavioral change mechanisms - Intermediate Outcome - I-OC 1.1 National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, private sector, and researchers prioritize, test, adapt and use innovation bundles	- Number of stakeholders co-designing testing, adapting and assessing innovation bundles - Number of stakeholders (farmer organizations, extension services etc) identifying, testing and validating - Number of partners, extension agents, NGOs and private sector actors sharing and scaling evidence-based and validated solutions and innovation bundles - Number of actors co-producing or engaging in identifying relevant evidence - Number of stakeholders involved in developing inclusive MFL plans - Number of stakeholders (farmer organizations,	- Marginalized people in selected landscapes are able and willing to engage on issues of quality of life, gender-transformative approaches (GTAs), social equity, food sovereignty. Their needs can be jointly identified, and the co-developed solutions enable them to act. - Landscape stakeholders engaged see the value in fair and GESI approaches and have the capacity to integrate them in their decision-making and actions. - CGIAR and MFL partners actively engage in the proposed knowledge sharing process to strengthen their influence in agenda settings and policy discourse through capacity sharing	- Colombia - Tunisia - Zimbabwe - Peru - Cambodia - Lao - People's Democratic Republic - Senegal - Kenya - Tanzania, - United Republic - The Socialist Republic of Viet Nam	On the go/ Quarterly actor engagement tracking tool by event: meetings, field trips, seminars, workshops, focus groups etc. Outcome journals filled by the MELIA focal point in each country whenever relevant information about changes in interactions or behavior related to use of innovations, capacities and knowledge emerge. Analysis by engagement level: engagement, training, design, testing, assessment, use	2025	2030	Food system actors engagement tracker from the AE initiative: Food System Actors engaged in the cocreation of agroecological innovations: Results of three years of engagement in eight countries. 6p. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/169475

MELIA Study title	MELIA type	Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Country	Methods and design approaches	Start date for the study	End date for the study	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
		- Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 7.1 Partners, national and sub-national public actors engaged by the MFL Program use knowledge and capacity to update their NBSAPs and LDN targets - Intermediate Outcome - I-OC 6 National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs, and researchers use data, tools and knowledge to optimize multifunctional landscape performance - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 2.3. National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters, and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs establish governance structures - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 6.1 National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs, development actors and researchers engage in assessment	- extension services etc) engaging in capacity sharing spaces and actions - Number of national and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs using science, evidence and capacities on MFL in their strategic planning and management activities - Number of polyvocal spaces/events intentionally integrating gender equality, youth and social inclusion-responsive and transformative approaches and methodologies - Number of landscape stakeholders who have participated in MFL decision-making processes with improved capacity - Number of national and sub-	- resources and activities that are user-centered and based on scientific evidence. - Partners and landscape stakeholders are convinced of the need for strong and effective adherence to the guiding principles of the community of practice on multifunctional landscapes and open data principles - A variety of national and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs, and researchers are convinced that robust and relevant evidence is a critical component for effective decision making. - Local communities living in landscapes are willing and able to engage in the design, and					

MELIA Study title	MELIA type	Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Country	Methods and design approaches	Start date for the study	End date for the study	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
		design and implementation - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 3.3 Consumer groups access knowledge on goods and services - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 6.2 National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs, and researchers contribute to data analysis or knowledge production - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 4.3 Policy-relevant actors at different levels use coordination mechanisms and institutions - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 2.2 National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters, and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs design inclusive plans - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 3.2. Local producer organizations, national and sub-national public actors and private sector	national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs, and researchers engaging in assessment framework design or implementation processes	development of the activities. All involved actors, including communities, NARES, academia, local and national governments, and CGIAR are willing to share and learn from the process and information. - Local communities living in landscapes are willing and able to engage in the design, and development of the activities. All involved actors, including communities, NARES, academia, local and national governments, and CGIAR are willing to share and learn from the process and information. - Policymakers at national and subnational scales, and across various sectors, are motivated to participate					

MELIA Study title	MELIA type	Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Country	Methods and design approaches	Start date for the study	End date for the study	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
		actors co-design or strengthen inclusive business models - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 1.1. National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, private sector, and researchers engage in identification, testing and validation - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 7.2 CGIAR and MFL stakeholders incorporate impact indicators in their strategies - Intermediate Outcome - I-OC 2. National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters, and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs benefit from inclusive planning, governance and management - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 4.1 National and sub-national policy actors co-produce and identify relevant evidence - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 2.1. National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders,		actively in the co-development, coordination and promotion of policy processes. Farmers and other FSAs are able to adopt, participate in, and scale MFL approaches. - Policy actors recognize the importance of cross-sectoral alignment and are motivated and willing to adapt their own mechanisms to MFL principles. - Landscape stakeholders are willing to collaborate to optimize landscape multifunctionality and are willing and have the capacity to reach a consensus. - Landscape stakeholders are willing to collaborate to design and establish inclusive governance and plans, and are willing and have the capacity to					

MELIA Study title	MELIA type	Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Country	Methods and design approaches	Start date for the study	End date for the study	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
		foresters and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs at the landscape level demonstrate improved capacity to optimize landscape multifunctionality - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 4.2 Policy-relevant actors at different levels use tools and capacities - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 3.4. National and sub-national public actors, as well as producer associations, private sector and finance actors develop innovative incentive mechanisms and financial mechanisms - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 3.1. Producer organization, local institutions and private sector actors improve their organizational and marketing actions and connections to other market actors - Intermediate Outcome - I-OC5 Marginalized people shape planning, governance, market and nonmarket		reach a consensus. - Landscape stakeholders are willing to collaborate to design and establish inclusive market and non-market mechanisms, and are willing and have the capacity to reach a consensus. Government provides the enabling policy framework to incentivize these activities. - Producer organizations, national and sub-national public actors, private sector actors, and finance actors are willing and able to articulate their efforts effectively to co-design, develop, implement, and scale market and financial innovations. All involved actors are willing to share and learn from the process and					

MELIA Study title	MELIA type	Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Country	Methods and design approaches	Start date for the study	End date for the study	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
		incentives - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 1.2. National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, private sector, and researchers share capacities to implement innovations - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 5.1 National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs, finance sector actors, and researchers, participate in polyvocal spaces and co-design policy, governance, business models, and solutions - Intermediate Outcome - I-OC 1.2 Program partners and extension agents, NGOs and private sector actors share and scale solutions and innovations - Intermediate Outcome - I-OC7 Partners in MFL sites increase their capacity to articulate and communicate knowledge on MFL innovations, business models, policies/institutions,		information. - Landscape stakeholders are willing to engage in new or existing Multistakeholder Platforms. Stakeholders are able to collaborate within the grassroots development agenda through active participation, trust building, and on-the-ground presence. Innovation bundles address stakeholder gaps (organizational, institutional, economic, and socioecological). - Landscape stakeholders are willing to engage in new or existing Multistakeholder Platforms. Stakeholders are able to collaborate within the grassroots development agenda through active participation, trust building, and on-the-					

MELIA Study title	MELIA type	Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	ssumption(s) assessed by this study	Country	Methods and design approaches	Start date for the study	End date for the study	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
		land-use planning, governance, social inclusion, behavioral change, and evidence on sustainable MFL management in policy arenas, scientific and practice communities		ground presence. Innovation bundles address stakeholder gaps (organizational, institutional, economic, and socioecological).					

MELIA Study title	MELIA type	Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Country	Methods and design approaches	Start date for the study	End date for the study	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
Household Level Adoption Studies	Adoption or diffusion studies addressing learning questions on the TOC	• 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-4. Marginalized people in each Multifunctional Landscape participate in the implementation of the plans, governance, organizational or institutional innovations, and business models, benefiting from the restoration and conservation of landscapes and transformation of eco-agri-food systems. • 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-3 National and sub-national public actors, market and finance sector actors design and implement coordinated, inclusive and coherent policy, institutional, organizational, market and non-market innovations that support the transition to thriving Multifunctional Landscapes • 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-1. Farmers, fishers, herders, foresters, forest and water users groups, national and sub-national public actors, and private sector	• Number of market, non-market and finance sector actors implementing market, non-market and financial innovations that promote transition to sustained MFLs	• Producer organizations, national and sub-national public actors, private sector actors, and finance actors are willing and able to articulate their efforts effectively to co-design, develop, implement, and scale market and financial innovations. - All involved actors are willing to share and learn from the process and information. • National and regional stakeholders and networks beyond living landscapes are willing and able to articulate their efforts with the program to scale innovations (in collaboration with the Scaling for Impact Program). • Marginalized people in selected landscapes are able and willing to engage on	• Peru • Tunisia • Colombia • India • Kenya	Leveraging on the baseline household surveys developed during the Agroecology and Nature Positive Initiatives, we will replicate these baselines in the same areas and with the same households, in order to study adoption of agroecological, nature positive, regenerative agriculture practices or market and non-market incentives. If resources are available and an appropriate counterfactual can be designed, given the baselines where based on randomized representative samples, these follow up surveys could be used to assess early impacts of the programme.	2029	2030	Build on baseline studies that have been collected in Colombia, Peru, Kenya, Tunisia and India by the Agroecology and Nature Positive Initiatives: Boukaka, Sedi-Anne; Azzarri, Carlo; Davis, Kristin E.; and De Falcis, Eleonora. 2024. Nature-Positive Solutions initiative baseline evaluation survey report: Kenya. CGIAR Initiative on Nature-Positive Solutions Survey Report July 2024. Washington, DC: International Food Policy Research Institute. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/149119 Boukaka, Sedi-Anne; Azzarri, Carlo; Davis, Kristin E.; and De Falcis, Eleonora. 2024. Nature-Positive Solutions initiative baseline evaluation survey report: Vietnam. CGIAR Initiative on Nature-Positive Solutions Survey Report July 2024. Washington, DC: International Food Policy Research Institute. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/149125 Lopera, Diana Carolina; Ordoñez, Juan Camilo; Azzarri, Carlo; Davis, Kristin E.; and De Falcis, Eleonora. 2024. Nature-Positive Solutions Initiative survey report: Colombia. Washington, DC and Rome, Italy: International Food Policy Research Institute and Alliance Bioversity and CIAT. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/172753 Orjuela Ramirez, G.; López-Estrada, S. (2024) Efficiency of agroecological practices in cacao production in Ucayali, Peru. 5 p.https://hdl.handle.net/10568/169

MELIA Study title	MELIA type	Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Country	Methods and design approaches	Start date for the study	End date for the study	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
		actors in the targeted landscapes apply technological, socio-ecological, policy and/or institutional innovations that enhance food production, ecosystem restoration and gains, biodiversity conservation and protection, social cohesion and resilience, and healthy diets in thriving Multifunctional Landscapes		issues of quality of life, gender-transformative approaches (GTAs), social equity, food sovereignty. Their needs can be jointly identified, and the co-developed solutions enable them to act. • National and subnational policy actors are convinced of the need for coordinated and coherent policy mechanisms that support the optimization of landscape multifunctionality.					218

MELIA Study title	MELIA type	Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Country	Methods and design approaches	Start date for the study	End date for the study	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
Impact assessment of selected agroecological and nature positive solutions on productivity, income and food security.	Causal Impact Assessment learning studies	2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-1. Farmers, fishers, herders, foresters, forest and water users groups, national and sub-national public actors, and private sector actors in the targeted landscapes apply technological, socio-ecological, policy and/or institutional innovations that enhance food production, ecosystem restoration and gains, biodiversity conservation and protection, social cohesion and resilience, and healthy diets in thriving Multifunctional Landscapes		- A variety of national and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs, and researchers are convinced that robust and relevant evidence is a critical component for effective decision making. - Landscape stakeholders are willing to take collaborative decisions on the prioritization of bundles of solutions and innovations and their capacities are built to a degree that they can use innovative tools and processes in decision-making, land-use planning and governance.	- The Socialist Republic of Viet Nam - Colombia - Tunisia - Peru - Kenya	(If feasible) Based on the targeting of farmer household intervened, the quantitative baselines in Colombia, Peru, Kenya, Tunisia and Vietnam can be used for a counterfactual study to assess impacts of selected agroecology and nature positive solutions on productivity, income and food security by applying Differences in Differences analysis combined with Propensity Score matching for robust counterfactual identification.	2029	2030	Build on baseline studies developed during the Initiatives: "Baseline studies have been collected in Colombia, Peru, Kenya, Tunisia and India by the Agroecology and Nature Positive Initiatives: Boukaka, Sedi-Anne; Azzarri, Carlo; Davis, Kristin E.; and De Falcis, Eleonora. 2024. Nature-Positive Solutions initiative baseline evaluation survey report: Kenya. CGIAR Initiative on Nature-Positive Solutions Survey Report July 2024. Washington, DC: International Food Policy Research Institute. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/149119 Boukaka, Sedi-Anne; Azzarri, Carlo; Davis, Kristin E.; and De Falcis, Eleonora. 2024. Nature-Positive Solutions initiative baseline evaluation survey report: Vietnam. CGIAR Initiative on Nature-Positive Solutions Survey Report July 2024. Washington, DC: International Food Policy Research Institute. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/149125 Lopera, Diana Carolina; Ordoñez, Juan Camilo; Azzarri, Carlo; Davis, Kristin E.; and De Falcis, Eleonora. 2024. Nature-Positive Solutions Initiative survey report: Colombia. Washington, DC and Rome, Italy: International Food Policy Research Institute and Alliance Bioversity and CIAT. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/172753 Orjuela Ramirez, G.; López-Estrada, S. (2024) Efficiency of agroecological practices in cacao production in Ucayali, Peru. 5

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									p. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/169218

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Outcome Evidencing/Outcome Trajectory Studies	Qualitative outcome study	• 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-4. Marginalized people in each Multifunctional Landscape participate in the implementation of the plans, governance, organizational or institutional innovations, and business models, benefiting from the restoration and conservation of landscapes and transformation of eco-agri-food systems. • 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-3 National and sub-national public actors, market and finance sector actors design and implement coordinated, inclusive and coherent policy, institutional, organizational, market and non-market innovations that support the transition to thriving Multifunctional Landscapes • 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-2. National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, local communities, private sector, NGOs and CSOs actively	• Number of landscape stakeholders implementing inclusive land use plans and associated governance mechanisms (investment plans, multistakeholder platforms, land and resource use plans etc.) to promote multifunctionality	• Producer organizations, national and sub-national public actors, private sector actors, and finance actors are willing and able to articulate their efforts effectively to co-design, develop, implement, and scale market and financial innovations. • All involved actors are willing to share and learn from the process and information. • Landscape stakeholders are willing and able to engage in multi-stakeholder and systemic processes based on co-design and capacity development according to specific needs and objectives that allow them uptake and scale the innovations at their decision-making level.	• Peru • Colombia • The Socialist Republic of Viet Nam • India • Kenya • Tunisia	Outcome Evidencing/Outcome Trajectory studies	2028	2030	Outcome evaluations carried out during the initiatives: Blundo Canto, G.; Owino, E.; Nekoye, H. (2024) Kiambu ALL Outcome Evidencing Report. 39 p. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/169711 Mouna, M.; Blundo Canto, G.M. (2024) Kef-Siliana ALL Outcome Evidencing Report. 45 p. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/169706 Ortiz, D.; Blundo Canto, G.; Orjuela, G. (2024) Ucayali outcome evidencing report. 42 p. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/170005 CGIAR Initiative on Livestock and Climate (2025) Technologies in a Social Context. Results Factsheet 1. Nairobi, Kenya: International Livestock Research Institute.

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		implement inclusive land and resource use planning and landscape governance (investment plans, multistakeholder platforms, etc.) to optimize landscape multi-functionality • 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-1. Farmers, fishers, herders, foresters, forest and water users groups, national and sub-national public actors, and private sector actors in the targeted landscapes apply technological, socio-ecological, policy and/or institutional innovations that enhance food production, ecosystem restoration and gains, biodiversity conservation and protection, social cohesion and resilience, and healthy diets in thriving Multifunctional Landscapes • 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-5 National, regional, and global actors use scientifically-sound evidence and capacities on the benefits of thriving		• National and regional stakeholders and networks beyond living landscapes are willing and able to articulate their efforts with the program to scale innovations (in collaboration with the Scaling for Impact Program). • Landscape stakeholders are willing to take collaborative decisions on the prioritization of bundles of solutions and innovations and their capacities are built to a degree that they can use innovative tools and processes in decision-making, land-use planning and governance. • Marginalized people in selected landscapes are able and willing to engage on issues of quality of life, gender-transformative approaches					

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		Multifunctional Landscapes to engage in global and regional agenda settings and policy discourse.		(GTAs), social equity, food sovereignty. Their needs can be jointly identified, and the co-developed solutions enable them to act.					

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Partnership quality evaluation tool	Other MELIA activity (please specify)	- Intermediate Outcome - I-OC 1.1 National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, private sector, and researchers prioritize, test, adapt and use innovation bundles - Intermediate Outcome - I-OC7 Partners in MFL sites increase their capacity to articulate and communicate knowledge on MFL innovations, business models, policies/institutions, land-use planning, governance, social inclusion, behavioral change, and evidence on sustainable MFL management in policy arenas, scientific and practice communities	Number of stakeholders co-designing testing, adapting and assessing innovation bundles	- CGIAR and MFL partners actively engage in the proposed knowledge sharing process to strengthen their influence in agenda settings and policy discourse through capacity sharing resources and activities that are user-centered and based on scientific evidence. - Partners and landscape stakeholders are convinced of the need for strong and effective adherence to the guiding principles of the community of practice on multifunctional landscapes and open data principles - Landscape stakeholders are willing to engage in new or existing Multistakeholder Platforms. Stakeholders are able to collaborate within the	- India - Cambodia - Colombia - Peru - Kenya - Zimbabwe - Tunisia - Tanzania, United Republic - The Socialist Republic of Viet Nam - Lao People's Democratic Republic - Senegal	Partnerships are a fundamental element of agroecological and nature positive approaches. Evaluating the quality of partnerships at key moments during the program life cycle would allow improved coordination, communication and scalability of program results. A specific partnership evaluation tool will be developed for the programme.	2026	2030	The Evaluation of Partnerships in CGIAR will guide framing of the strategy to evaluate partnerships in MFL: https://iaes.cgiar.org/evaluation/publications/evaluation-partnerships-cgiar

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				grassroots development agenda through active participation, trust building, and on-the-ground presence. Innovation bundles address stakeholder gaps (organizational, institutional, economic, and socioecological).					

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Policy Change Analyses	Tracing of scaling activities and policy advice, as a base for long-term, large scale impact assessments	- Intermediate Outcome - I-OC4 National governments, subnational and local policy actors use evidence - Intermediate Outcome - AoW-IOC 2.3. National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters, and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs establish governance structures 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-3 National and sub-national public actors, market and finance sector actors design and implement coordinated, inclusive and coherent policy, institutional, organizational, market and non-market innovations that support the transition to thriving Multifunctional Landscapes 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-2. National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, local communities, private sector, NGOs and CSOs actively implement inclusive land and resource use	- Number of landscape stakeholders implementing inclusive land use plans and associated governance mechanisms (investment plans, multistakeholder platforms, land and resource use plans etc.) to promote multifunctionality - Number of national, subnational and local policy actors using evidence in policy processes (e.g. citations of evidence in policy and incentives documents, public statements, fundraising actions; prioritized investments) - Number of policy innovations that support the transition to sustained MFLs - Number of land use plans, governance, organizational or institutional	- Marginalized people in selected landscapes are able and willing to engage on issues of quality of life, gender-transformative approaches (GTAs), social equity, food sovereignty. Their needs can be jointly identified, and the co-developed solutions enable them to act. • Policymakers at national and subnational scales, and across various sectors, are motivated to participate actively in the co-development, coordination and promotion of policy processes. Farmers and other FSAs are able to adopt, participate in, and scale MFL approaches. • National and subnational policy relevant actors are convinced of the		Tracing influence on policy processes at multiple scales through analysis of governance and policy documents influenced by the research of the science programme	2026	2030	Policy tracing work carried out during the initiatives: Hassen Ouerghemmi, Aymen Frija, Ali M. Oumer, Boubaker Dhehibi, Nehring Ryan. (26/10/2023). Mapping Policy Actors for Enhanced Engagement Towards Agroecology Transition: Case of Tunisia. Beirut, Lebanon: International Center for Agricultural Research in the Dry Areas (ICARDA). Place, Frank. 2023. Agroecology Initiative policy tracker guideline and tool. CGIAR System Organization. Singh, Sonali; and Maliappan, Sudarshan. 2024. Baseline review of policies in India: Understanding the policy context for facilitating agroecological transition. Agroecology Initiative Brief January 2024. CGIAR System Organization. https://hdl.handle.net/10568/139549 Chiduwa, M. S., Marennya, P. P., Ngoma, H., Nohayi., Ngowenani., & Chimonyo, V. G. P. (2023). Assessing the opportunities for agroecological transition in Zimbabwe: A review current policies. CGIAR. Arce, A.; Ivanova, Y.; Tristan Febres, M.C.; Pareja, P. (2023) WP4 - Peru: Synthesis of policies and institutions toward an agroecological transition. 18 p. Otieno, G.; Sikinyi, E.; Vernoooy, R.; Fadda, C.; Halewood, M. (2023) How policies influence smallholder farmers' access to and use of genetic resources in three East African countries. Rome (Italy): Bioversity International 48 p. ISBN: 978-92-9255-276-3 Otieno, K.P. 2024. A National Land

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		planning and landscape governance (investment plans, multistakeholder platforms, etc.) to optimize landscape multi-functionality - Intermediate Outcome - I-OC 2. National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders, foresters, and fishers, private sector, NGOs and CSOs benefit from inclusive planning, governance and management - Intermediate Outcome - I-OC5 Marginalized people shape planning, governance, market and nonmarket incentives	innovations, and business models that explicitly address barriers and visions of marginalized people in each MFL	need for evidence-based decision-making and are able to integrate the evidence produced in their actions. - Program partners are willing and able to effectively engage with and influence decision-makers at national and regional levels, supporting the scaling of inclusive market mechanisms and policy processes. - Government provides the enabling policy framework for suitable governance, management, and coordination structures. Landscape stakeholders are willing to collaborate to design and establish inclusive governance and plans, and are willing and have the capacity to					Policy Review in Kenya: Rangelands and Pastoralists' Perspective. Nairobi, Kenya: ILRI.

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				reach a consensus.					

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System Based Theory of Change	Program/project evaluation or review	• 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-4. Marginalized people in each Multifunctional Landscape participate in the implementation of the plans, governance, organizational or institutional innovations, and business models, benefiting from the restoration and conservation of landscapes and transformation of eco-agri-food systems. • 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-3 National and sub-national public actors, market and finance sector actors design and implement coordinated, inclusive and coherent policy, institutional, organizational, market and non-market innovations that support the transition to thriving Multifunctional Landscapes • 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-2. National and sub-national public actors, farmers, herders and fishers, local communities, private sector, NGOs and CSOs actively	• Number of landscape stakeholders implementing inclusive land use plans and associated governance mechanisms (investment plans, multistakeholder platforms, land and resource use plans etc.) to promote multifunctionality • Number of land use plans, governance, organizational or institutional innovations, and business models that explicitly address barriers and visions of marginalized people in each MFL • Number of market, non-market and finance sector actors implementing market, non-market and financial innovations that promote transition to sustained MFLs		• India • Tunisia • Peru • Kenya	System Based Theory of Change: in order to analyze how the changes at the landscape level influenced by the Program will generate changes at the country level and be influenced by changes at the country level, we will implement System Based Theory of Change methodology developed by Worldfish (see references in Annex 2). We will engage relevant landscape stakeholders in pilot landscapes (e.g. Peru, Kenya, Tunisia, India) in 2025/2026 to identify potential impacts at the national level (nodal points of change) and then re-evaluate in 2028 (mid-term) and 2030 (final evaluation) how these evolved and	2025	2030	This study builds on recent applications of the methodology: Timothy Manyise, Cristiano Rossignoli, Domenico Dentoni. (30/12/2024). Technical Guide: Systems-based approach to understanding, steering and guiding change in Aquatic foods. Bayan Lepas, Malaysia: WorldFish (WF).

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		implement inclusive land and resource use planning and landscape governance (investment plans, multistakeholder platforms, etc.) to optimize landscape multi-functionality • 2030 Outcome - 2030 OC-1. Farmers, fishers, herders, foresters, forest and water users groups, national and sub-national public actors, and private sector actors in the targeted landscapes apply technological, socio-ecological, policy and/or institutional innovations that enhance food production, ecosystem restoration and gains, biodiversity conservation and protection, social cohesion and resilience, and healthy diets in thriving Multifunctional Landscapes	• Number of policy innovations that support the transition to sustained MFLs			what was the contribution of the MFL Program interventions to these changes. This will allow us to identify the most impactful Outcomes related to the Impact Areas and orient Outcome Evidencing studies for efficient use of MELIA resources.			